

CITY: PG 3

L-G and CM urge students to link edu with nation-building



NATION: PG 5

Rebels move against Palaniswami



FILM: PG 12

‘Thoroughly enjoyed working with Saif’



WPI inflation spikes to 42-month high as West Asia crisis raises energy prices

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Wholesale price inflation surged to a 42-month high of 8.3 per cent in April, driven largely by a sharp rise in energy costs linked to disruptions from the ongoing West Asia conflict, according to official data released on Thursday. The latest figure marks a steep jump from 3.88 per cent recorded in March and 0.85 per cent in April last year. Analysts at Barclays noted that the month-on-month rise in wholesale inflation was the sharpest ever seen in the current data series. Fuel and power prices were the primary contributors to the surge, with inflation in this category climbing to 24.71 per cent in April from 1.05 per cent in March. Inflation in crude petroleum alone spiked to 88.06 per cent, the highest level since October 2021. The increase comes amid supply disruptions following the West Asia war and a blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, which has affected crude imports into India and pushed global prices higher. **Continued on P4**

Modi, Lavrov discuss Ukraine, West Asia, push for diplomatic solutions

BRICS FM’s meet: India flags serious concerns over West Asia crisis, unilateral sanctions, warns of energy and maritime crisis

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: India stood at the centre of global diplomacy on Thursday as New Delhi hosted the BRICS Foreign Ministers’ Meeting, with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar raising grave concerns over the West Asia crisis, mounting economic uncertainty, and the damaging effects of unilateral sanctions on developing nations, while Prime Minister Narendra Modi received Russian Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov and reiterated India’s consistent commitment to dialogue and peaceful resolution of conflicts. The two-day conclave, convened under India’s chairmanship of the influential bloc, drew senior diplomats from across the BRICS grouping, including Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi, Brazilian For-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi during a meeting with Russian Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov PTI

eign Minister Mauro Vieira, Indonesian Foreign Minister Sugiono, and South Africa’s Minister for International Relations Ronald Lamola. The visiting dignitaries made a joint call on Prime Minister Modi, who also met Lavrov separately ahead of the opening session. In a post on X after meeting Lavrov, Modi said he was

KEY POINTS

- » S Jaishankar warned of risks to energy supplies and maritime stability, especially in the Strait of Hormuz and Red Sea
- » India stressed the need for safe and uninterrupted global maritime trade routes
- » Jaishankar flagged “grave humanitarian implications” of the Gaza conflict and backed a two-state solution
- » He described the current global situation as a “convergence of challenges,” not isolated crises
- » Developing nations face mounting pressure from energy shortages, food and fertiliser insecurity, inflation, and disrupted supply chains

“pleased to receive Russia’s Foreign Minister” and expressed thanks for an update on the progress of India and Russia’s Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership. “We also exchanged

views on various regional and global issues, including situation in Ukraine and West Asia. Reiterated our consistent support for efforts aimed at peaceful **Continued on P4**

‘MERA BHARAT, MERA YOGDAN’

Delhi CM announces WFH, no-car day, online meets after PM’s appeal

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday unveiled a series of measures aimed at conserving fuel and resources, aligning with an appeal by Prime Minister Narendra Modi amid global uncertainty over energy supplies. Announcing a three-month public campaign titled “Mera Bharat, Mera Yogdan,” Gupta said all Delhi government offices will adopt a two-day work-from-home system each week, while private firms will be encouraged to follow suit. Ministers, officials and staff, including the chief minister, will commute via Metro on Mondays, alongside a weekly voluntary no-vehicle day for residents. Fuel use in government vehicles will be reduced by 20 per cent, lowering petrol and diesel limits from 250 and 200 litres to 200 and 160 litres. To offset the shift to public transport, employees’ travel allowance will rise by 10 per cent. Gupta also announced a one-

CLOSER LOOK

- » 2-day weekly WFH for Delhi government offices
- » Private sector urged to adopt similar WFH model
- » Weekly voluntary no-vehicle day proposed
- » Govt vehicle fuel quota cut by 20%
- » Petrol limit 250→200 litres; diesel 200→160 litres

year suspension of official foreign visits and a halt on large government events for three months. Office timings have been revised, with Delhi government offices operating from 10.30 am to 7 pm and municipal offices from 8.30 am to 5 pm. At least half of official meetings will be conducted online, and institutions will be urged to adopt virtual modes where feasible. The measures aim to cut fuel imports and ease pressure on foreign exchange reserves, officials said. **See P3**

COVERING 36.73 CRORE VOTERS

Phase 3 of voter roll update begins May 30 across 16 states, 3 UTs

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Election Commission of India on Thursday announced the rollout of phase 3 of its Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls, a large-scale exercise that will cover 36.73 crore voters across 16 states and three Union Territories. The revision will begin on May 30 and proceed in phases, the poll body said. The states and Union Territories included in this phase are Delhi, Odisha, Mizoram, Sikkim, Manipur, Uttarakhand, Andhra Pradesh, Arunachal Pradesh, Haryana, Chandigarh, Telangana, Punjab, Karnataka, Meghalaya, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, Nagaland, Tripura, and Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu. Among these, Punjab, Jharkhand, Karnataka and Telangana are governed by opposition parties. According to the Commission, over 3.94 lakh booth level officers will conduct door-to-door verification of electors as part of the exercise. They will be supported by around 3.42 lakh booth level agents appointed by political parties during the enumeration process. **Continued on P4**

Storms, lightning claim 111 lives in Uttar Pradesh



This combo image shows a man being flung nearly 50 ft into the air along with a tin roof during a powerful storm, in Bareilly district, Uttar Pradesh, on Thursday PTI

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: At least 111 people were killed and more than 72 injured across Uttar Pradesh after powerful dust storms, heavy rainfall and lightning strikes battered several districts over the past 24 hours, triggering large-scale damage to homes, power infrastructure and transport networks, officials said on Thursday. The devastation was most severe in the Varanasi, Prayagraj and Kanpur divisions, where strong winds uprooted trees, brought down elec-

» MAJOR CAUSES: LIGHTNING STRIKES, FALLING TREES, AND COLLAPSING STRUCTURES

tricity poles and disrupted rail and road traffic. Authorities launched overnight rescue and restoration operations as district administrations scrambled to clear debris and assist affected residents.

According to the Uttar Pradesh Relief and Revenue Department, Bhadohi reported the highest number of fatalities at **Continued on P4**

US may drop fraud, bribery charges against Adani: Report

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The US Justice Department is reportedly set to drop criminal fraud and bribery charges against Indian billionaire Gautam Adani linked to an alleged \$265 million corruption scheme tied to India’s largest solar power project, according to a Bloomberg report cited by India Today.

The criminal case is linked to an alleged \$265 million bribery and fraud scheme, the report said. The development could bring relief to the Adani Group chairman more than a year after US prosecutors in New York accused him and other executives of orchestrating a multibillion-dollar corruption network tied to India’s largest solar power project. **Continued on P4**

Justice Swarana Sharma starts contempt case against Kejriwal, others; transfers excise case

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Thursday initiated criminal contempt proceedings against several leaders of the Aam Aadmi Party, including Arvind Kejriwal, Manish Sisodia, Sanjay Singh and Saurabh Bhardwaj, over alleged attempts to malign a sitting judge through social media posts linked to the excise policy case. Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma said the actions of the leaders and others amounted, at a prima facie level, to criminal contempt under the Contempt of Court Act, 1971. She observed that the conduct appeared designed to “scandalise the court, lower the authority of the institution of justice, interfere with the administration of justice and intimidate the independent exercise of judicial function.” The court also named AAP leaders Durgesh Pathak and Vinay Mishra, along with an unidentified user on X, in the proceedings. Justice Sharma took exception to posts that attributed political affiliations to her and circulated what she described as a misleading, edited video of a speech delivered at an educational institution in Varanasi. In a detailed order delivered over more than an hour, the judge said a “parallel narrative” was being constructed through selective clips and commentary online. **Continued on P4**

Xi hails US-China relations, but warns Trump over Taiwan

Donald Trump agrees ties should shape a better global future

MPOST BUREAU

BEIJING: Chinese President Xi Jinping hailed the US-China relationship as the world’s most consequential, telling President Donald Trump: “We must make it work and never mess it up.” Earlier in the summit on Thursday, Xi warned Taiwan “is the most important issue in China-US relations” and it could create a “very dangerous situation” if mishandled, according to a CNN report. The conflict, and ensuing global energy crisis, were a key topic of conversation. Trump said Xi offered help resolving



President Donald Trump participates in a welcome ceremony with China’s President Xi Jinping at the Great Hall of the People, on Thursday AP/PTI

the war, though US Secretary of State Marco Rubio said the US isn’t seeking assistance from Beijing. The White House said the

CLOSER LOOK

- » Leaders discuss Iran war, energy crisis, and global trade tensions
- » Trump says Xi offered help on Iran; US declines external assistance
- » Both sides agree Strait of Hormuz must remain open for energy flows

two leaders agreed on the importance of fully opening the Strait of Hormuz, a chokepoint vital to the oil trade. **Continued on P4**

SWEARING-IN ON MAY 18

Cong names Satheesan as next Kerala CM

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: Ending days of suspense and speculation, the Congress on Thursday named V D Satheesan as the next chief minister of Kerala. After ten days of intense deliberations, top-level huddles in Thiruvananthapuram and Delhi, fictional battle, and lobbying within the party, the Congress finally chose V D Satheesan, the outgoing Leader of the Opposition over heavyweights like KC Venugopal and Ramesh Chennithala. Venugopal reportedly enjoyed the backing of a majority of the newly elected Con-



Congress workers offer sweets to Chief Minister-designate V D Satheesan after the announcement of his name as the next Kerala Chief Minister, in Thiruvananthapuram PTI

gress MLAs but the public sentiment appeared in favour of Satheesan. The Congress high command analysed the assessment of public mood, mass appeal and political optics

ahead of future electoral battles in tilting the scales in favour of V D Satheesan. Within Congress circles, Venugopal, a trusted Rahul Gandhi aide, was viewed as a

CLOSER LOOK

- » Satheesan chosen over K C Venugopal and Ramesh Chennithala
- » Venugopal reportedly had backing of majority of newly elected Congress MLAs
- » Public sentiment and political optics tilted leadership decision toward Satheesan

formidable contender. It was generally believed that his loyalty to the Gandhi family and his years as AICC general secretary would strengthen his claim. **Continued on P4**

SURVIVOR SUSTAINED MINOR INJURIES

Woman gang-raped in sleeper bus; driver and conductor arrested

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A 30-year-old woman was allegedly gang-raped inside a private sleeper bus in northwest Delhi, in an incident that has triggered fresh concern over women’s safety in the national capital and drawn comparisons with the 2012 Nirbhaya case. The Delhi Police said the driver and conductor of the bus have been arrested and the vehicle seized, while a detailed investigation is underway into the assault that took place late on May 11. According to police officials, the woman, who works



A private sleeper bus parked, in which a woman returning home from work in the Mangolpuri area was allegedly dragged and gang-raped by the driver and conductor, in New Delhi, on Thursday PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Incident occurred late on May 11 near Saraswati Vihar bus stand
- » Survivor was returning home from factory work in Mangolpuri
- » Accused allegedly dragged her into bus after she asked for time
- » Bus driven towards Nangloi where assault took place

at a factory in Mangolpuri and lives in a slum cluster in Pitampura, was returning home on foot when the incident occurred near the B-Block bus **Continued on P4**

Indian cargo ship sinks after strike near Oman, MEA calls attack unacceptable

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: An Indian-flagged vessel sank off the coast of Oman after coming under attack in the early hours of Wednesday as regional tensions continued to disrupt maritime movement through the Strait of Hormuz, officials said. The Ministry of External Affairs described the strike as “unacceptable” and said all 14 crew members onboard were safe. “The attack on an Indian-flagged ship off the coast of Oman yesterday is unacceptable and we deplore the fact that commercial shipping and civilian mariners continue to be targeted,” the min-

The vessel, identified as Haji Ali, was a traditional Indian dhow measuring 57 metres in length and 14 metres in width

istry said, adding that Omani authorities were thanked for rescuing the crew. The vessel, identified as Haji Ali, was a traditional Indian dhow measuring 57 metres in length and 14 metres in width. It was travelling from Somalia to Sharjah in the United Arab Emirates when it was hit in Omani waters, triggering a fire that eventually led to its sinking. **Continued on P4**

NEW DELHI: India has prohibited sugar exports with immediate effect until September 30, 2026, aiming to improve domestic availability and keep prices in check. The Directorate General of Foreign Trade, in a May 13 notification, said the export policy for raw, white and refined sugar has been shifted from “restricted” to “prohibited” for the period or until further orders. The curbs do not apply to shipments to the European Union and the United States under the CXL and Tariff Rate Quota arrangements. Exports under advance authorisation, government-to-government deals and consignments already in the pipeline are also exempt.

For the 2025-26 marketing year, authorities had permitted nearly 16 lakh tonnes of exports, though shipments were expected at 7.5 to 8 lakh tonnes. Sugar output rose 7.32 per cent to 27.52 million tonnes till April, with full-year production estimated at 29.3 million tonnes, according to ISMA. Pushan Sharma of Crisil Intelligence said the move reflects tightening supplies. Prices have increased about 4 per cent year-on-year, with a 5 per cent rise expected for the season. Closing stocks are projected at 3.8 million tonnes, about 1.5 months of consumption. **See P10**

CCTV FOOTAGE SEIZED

Female teacher nabbed in Janakpuri child rape case

Assault took place during school hours, say Delhi Police

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A female teacher of a private school in west Delhi's Janakpuri area has been arrested in connection with the alleged rape of a three-year-old girl by a 57-year-old school caretaker, a police officer said on Thursday.

The teacher will be produced before a court later in the day, he said.

The incident came to light on May 1 after a woman lodged a complaint at the Janakpuri Police Station, alleging that her daughter was sexually assaulted during school hours on April 30, the second day after her admission to the school.

According to the complaint, the child complained of pain after returning home.

When questioned by her mother, she allegedly said that

she had been taken to an isolated area inside the school where the caretaker sexually assaulted her.

Based on the complaint, the police registered a case under Section 64(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and Section 6 of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act.

On May 1, the police arrested the caretaker after he was identified by the child and sent to judicial custody.

On May 7, a city court granted him bail despite opposition from the prosecution.

The police said they would file an appeal in the high court against the bail order.

The victim's mother earlier alleged that a teacher was also involved in the case and claimed that the family was made to wait for several hours at the police station.

The police denied the allegations and said the investigation was conducted in a fair and professional manner.

They said they had seized CCTV footage, DVRs and other exhibits as evidence.

AAP MP to meet Delhi L-G, demand action

NEW DELHI: AAP MP Sanjay Singh on Thursday said he would seek an appointment with Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu over the alleged rape of a three-year-old girl at a private school in Janakpuri and demand strict action. Addressing a press conference, Singh said he would take a delegation to discuss steps to ensure justice for the child and accountability in the case.

He added that if no appointment was granted, the party would decide its future course of action. The remarks came after protests led by Saurabh Bhadwaj outside Raj Niwas. The case relates to the alleged assault on May 1, for which a 57-year-old school caretaker was arrested and later granted bail. MP05T

Police busts counterfeit luxury goods racket; 1 held

NEW DELHI: A 35-year-old man was arrested for allegedly selling counterfeit products of several international luxury brands from a shop in north-west Delhi's Shalimar Bagh, police said on Thursday.

The accused, Mohit Sachdeva, was arrested during a raid at a shop in Shalimar Bagh, police in a statement said. The police said a huge quantity of fake branded products, including clothing, watches, sunglasses, perfumes, deodorants, belts, handbags and footwear bearing counterfeit labels of reputed international brands, was recovered from the premises.

According to the police, the recovered items included counterfeit products of brands such as Prada, Lacoste, Balenciaga, Burberry, Gant and Hugo Boss.

Among the seized articles were 55 Prada T-shirts, 17 jeans, 40 sunglasses and several accessories, including belts, handbags and wallets. Police also recovered 44 Lacoste T-shirts, 55 Balenciaga T-shirts, 39 Burberry T-shirts, 34 Gant shirts, and 10 Hugo Boss wrist watches, along with several deodorants, caps, belts and shoes. The police said the accused allegedly procured and sold clothing items, sunglasses, caps, belts, watches, perfume, deodorants and footwear by affixing counterfeit labels. MP05T

Man jumps into canal over family dispute, wife rescued by locals in Fbd

OUR CORRESPONDENT

FARIDABAD: A 25-year-old man allegedly jumped into the Agra Canal near Palla Bridge here after a family dispute, while his wife was prevented by locals from taking a similar step, police said on Thursday.

The man, identified as Sudhanshu, a resident of Chetan colony, is missing and police along with fire brigade personnel are searching for him in the canal, officials said.

According to police, Sudhanshu was at home on Wednesday evening when his mother allegedly scolded him for not working. Upset over the issue he left the house with his wife and went to the bridge over the Agra Canal near sector 37.

On reaching the bridge Sudhanshu allegedly jumped into the canal, police said.



His wife also attempted to jump into the canal but was stopped by people present nearby, they said.

Locals informed Palla police station about the incident. Police later escorted the woman back to her home after recording details.

"The teams are searching for the youth and efforts are underway but he has not been traced yet," SHO Satya Prakash of Palla police station said.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa on Thursday said that hundreds of "litter pickers" have been deployed across the national capital as part of the government's push for a cleaner city.

Sharing visuals of the litter picker machines, also known as "gobblers", Sirsa wrote on his social media account on X (formerly Twitter), "In the direction of realizing the dream of a Clean Delhi, Healthy Delhi, hundreds of litter pickers are engaged in keeping the city clean and tidy."

"Under the leadership of the Honourable Chief Minister... the Delhi government is working with full commitment to strengthen the capital's cleaning system so that Delhi residents can get a clean and

Intruders barge into home; decamp with cash & jewellery worth Rs 8L after tying up woman

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Two unidentified men allegedly barged into a residence in east Delhi's Trilok Puri area on Thursday, and robbed cash and jewellery worth around Rs 8 lakh after tying a lone woman in the house to a bed, police said.

According to police, the incident took place around 11 am when the woman, identified as Firoza, was alone at her residence, and the main gate was open.

Police said a PCR call regarding the robbery was received at Mayur Vihar police



station around 11.15 am, following which a team rushed to the spot.

In her statement to police, the woman alleged that two unknown persons entered the house, overpowered her, tied her hands and legs, and gagged

“In her statement to police, the woman alleged that two unknown persons entered the house, overpowered her, tied her hands and legs, and gagged her mouth using tape and cloth”

her mouth using tape and cloth before tying her to a bed.

The accused allegedly took the keys of the almirah from her purse, opened the locker and decamped with gold and silver jewellery and cash worth around Rs 8 lakh, police said.

A crime team was called to the spot and forensic examination, photography and inspection of the scene were carried out. Fingerprints were also collected from the house, police said.

An FIR under relevant sections related to robbery has been registered at Mayur Vihar police station and investigation is underway, the officer said.

Police said multiple teams have been formed to identify and trace the accused.

CCTV footage from nearby areas is being scanned and all possible leads are being pursued, the officer said.

Dentist held in Rs 1 crore property scam

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A dentist accused of cheating multiple people of more than Rs 1 crore through fraudulent property deals in northeast Delhi has been arrested after remaining absconding for seven months, police said on Thursday.

The accused, identified as Majahar Khan (44), a resident of Yamuna Vihar, allegedly used his reputation as a dental practitioner to gain the trust of victims before duping them in



a series of property fraud cases, police in a statement said.

According to the police, Khan, popularly known as "Dr Sahab" in the locality, is a qualified BDS and MDS graduate who initially practised den-

tristry in the Khureji area before shifting to property dealings in Yamuna Vihar, it read.

Police said Khan sold a Yamuna Vihar property to different people despite it being mortgaged with a private bank.

"He concealed material facts regarding the ownership and mortgage status of the property and induced several people into financial transactions," Deputy Commissioner of Police (Crime Branch) Pankaj Kumar said in the statement. The accused was

declared a proclaimed offender and was wanted in multiple cheating and fraud cases.

A team tracked Khan through technical surveillance, following which he was apprehended from Ganeshpur Toll Plaza in Uttar Pradesh, police said, adding that an SUV was also seized from his possession.

Police said at least eight FIRs and two non-cognisable reports related to criminal intimidation are linked to the accused. Further investigation is underway.

Blaze in scrap godown: DFS

NEW DELHI: A fire broke out at a metal and scrap wood godown in west Delhi's Ramesh Nagar area on Thursday morning, officials said.

No casualties have been reported.

The Delhi Fire Services (DFS) received a call regarding the blaze at 7.56 am, following which five fire tenders were rushed to the spot.

The fire was brought under control by around 9.30 am, a DFS official said. MP05T

Nine Special CPs transferred in Delhi Police admin revamp

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: In a major administrative reshuffle in the Delhi Police, the Delhi Government on Tuesday ordered the transfer and posting of nine Special Commissioners of Police with immediate effect following recommendations made by the Police Establishment Board.

The order, approved by Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena, was issued by the Home Department of the Government of the National Capital Territory of Delhi.

According to the official notification, 1994-batch IPS officer Neeraj Thakur has been shifted from the post of Special Commissioner of Police (Traffic Division) to Special Commissioner of Police, Law and Order Division Zone-II.

Senior IPS officer Devesh Chandra Srivastava, a 1995-batch officer serving as Special CP (Crime) with additional charge of the Perception Man-

Atul Katiyar has been shifted from the Welfare Division to the Vigilance Division

agement and Media Cell Division, has been posted as Special CP, Law and Order Division Zone-I. Another 1995-batch IPS officer, Lalrinsanga David, will continue in Operations (PCR and Communication) with additional responsibilities of SPUWAC and SPUNER.

Manish Kumar Agarwal, a 1996-batch officer who was handling the Intelligence Division along with the Public Transport Safety Division, has been appointed as Special CP of the Traffic Division.

Ajay Chaudhry, previously posted in the Vigilance Division with additional charge of SPUWAC, has been transferred as Special CP, Protective Security Division.

IPS officer Hargobinder Singh Dhaliwal, who recently

arrived in Delhi, has been appointed as Special CP (Crime) with additional charge of the Perception Management, Media Cell and Legal Division.

Further, Atul Katiyar has been shifted from the Welfare Division to the Vigilance Division with additional charge of the Welfare and Licensing Division. Vijay Kumar, serving as Special CP, Armed Police, will continue in the same role with added responsibility of the Public Transport Safety Division. K. Jagadesan has been moved from the Protective Security Division to the Intelligence Division with additional charge of MD/DPHC.

The transfer order was signed by Principal Secretary (Home) Santosh D. Vaidya and copies were forwarded to the Ministry of Home Affairs, the Delhi Police Commissioner, the Chief Minister's Office and other concerned authorities for immediate implementation. The notification was issued on May 13, 2026.

Husband and brother nabbed in newlywed woman's murder case

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A 28-year-old newlywed woman was allegedly strangled to death by her husband following a quarrel over dowry and money-related disputes in central Delhi's Nabi Karim area, leading to the arrest of two persons, police said.

The accused were identified as Ejaz (39) and Sarfaraz (29), both residents of Vaishali in Bihar.

According to the police, the incident came to light on the night of May 8 after a PCR call was received from a landlord in Laxmanpuri, Nabi Karim, reporting a foul smell from a tenant's locked room.

When police reached the spot, they found the decomposed body of a woman lying on a bed inside the rented accommodation.

The deceased, a resident of Haldwani in Uttarakhand, had married Ejaz on April 26 and the couple had recently started living together in the rented room, police said.

An FIR under relevant sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita was registered



at Nabi Karim Police Station and an investigation was launched. Police said allegations of dowry harassment were also levelled against Ejaz and his brother Sarfaraz by the victim's father, following which Sarfaraz was arrested on May 10.

A dedicated police team carried out technical surveillance after the accused absconded. During interrogation, Ejaz allegedly confessed that he strangled his wife during an argument on the intervening night of May 6 and 7 before locking the room and fleeing to Kolkata.

Police also recovered the deceased's Oppo A18 mobile phone, which the accused allegedly sold for Rs 2,500 to finance his escape.

E-ambulance unveiled at Safdarjung Hospital

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: An e-ambulance has been donated to VMMC and Safdarjung Hospital by DFY India under its CSR initiative to support patient movement within the hospital premises, officials said on Thursday.

The initiative has been launched in line with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision to promote green mobility, sustainable healthcare infrastructure, and reduce fuel dependence through clean energy solutions.

The e-Ambulance was inaugurated by hospital Director Dr Kavita Sharma in the presence of Medical Superintendent Dr Charu Bamba and Doctors For You (DFY) India president Dr Rajat Jain, the hospital said in a statement.

According to the statement, the e-ambulance will facilitate quick and eco-friendly transportation of patients within the hospital campus, improving accessibility and patient support services.

"VMMC and Safdarjung Hospital caters to a large number of patients every day, and initiatives that strengthen

We are honoured to collaborate with VMMC and Safdarjung hospital in contributing towards patient welfare

patient support services are always valuable. We appreciate DFY India for contributing the e-Ambulance under its CSR initiative, which will help enhance patient mobility within the hospital campus in an environment-friendly manner," Sharma said.

Dr Rajat Jain said DFY India remained committed to supporting meaningful healthcare initiatives through CSR activities.

"We are honoured to collaborate with VMMC and Safdarjung hospital in contributing towards patient welfare and sustainable healthcare solutions," he said.

The initiative reflects the growing collaboration between healthcare institutions and corporate organizations to improve patient-centric services and promote green healthcare practices, the statement said.



“Machines have been deployed in several locations of central Delhi and a handful of locations in South and North Delhi

better environment," he further wrote.

An official said, "The machines have been deployed in several locations of central Delhi and a handful of locations in South and North Delhi."

The locations include entire outer circle of Connaught Place (CP); inner circle, middle circle and radial road CP; the stretch covering Baba Khark Singh

(BKS) Marg, GPO (Gol Dak Khana), Bangla Sahib Marg, SBS Market and Gole Market; the stretch through Pandit Pant Marg, Imtiyaz Khan Road, Sansad Marg Roundabout and Patel Chowk roundabout; the stretch covering Janpath, Tibbati Market, Gujarati Market, Janpath Market and Sansad Marg upto Tolstoy Marg (Palika Kendra Red Light).

"The locations also include

the Outer Circle of CP to Shanker Market and Barakhamba Service Lane, Municipal Market, Babar Road, Bengali Market, Tansen Marg, Mandi House Plaza, Man Singh Road, Motilal Nehru Marg, Lok Kalyan Marg, Teen Murti Lane, surroundings of PM House, new PMO Prime Chowk, Krishna Menon Marg, K. Kamraj Road, Sunhari Bagh Road and Khan Market," the official added.

The litter pickers have also been deployed in the Khanna Market, Lodhi Colony, 3rd Avenue Roads, Africa Avenue, Tekendrajeet Marg, Nyaya Marg, Kaka Nagar, C Hexagon inner and outer portions.

Locations other than in and around central Delhi also include Babu Market, Maharaja Agrasen Marg, AIIMS, Safdarjung Hospital and Sarojini Nagar Market.

MINISTERS, OFFICIALS TO AVOID FOREIGN VISITS FOR ONE YEAR

CM announces Metro Monday, WFH policy & public transport incentives

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Launching the 90-day “Mera Bharat, Mera Yogdan” campaign, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday announced sweeping measures ranging from work-from-home policies and fuel cuts to Metro incentives and restrictions on official foreign travel, saying the Delhi Government would transform Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s “Nation First” call into a mass movement driven by public participation and responsible living.

Addressing a press conference at the Delhi Secretariat alongside Cabinet ministers, Gupta said global economic uncertainty, tensions in West Asia and rising fuel costs made conservation a national responsibility. “Delhi Government will transform PM Modi Ji’s ‘Nation First’ call into a mass movement,” she said, adding that the campaign aimed to involve institutions and citizens in building an “Atmanirbhar Bharat”.

The Chief Minister announced that all Delhi Government departments, except essential public services, would implement a two-day work-from-home system every week,



likely on Wednesdays and Saturdays, according to sources. Private companies and institutions were also encouraged to adopt similar arrangements. The Labour Department will establish a single-window help desk and call centre for implementation support. Hospitals, fire services, prisons, public transport, electricity and water supply departments will remain exempt.

In a major fuel-saving measure, the government reduced official petrol allowances by up to 20 per cent. Vehicles previously entitled to 200 litres will now receive 160 litres, while the 250-litre limit has been reduced to 200 litres. Gupta also announced that every Mon-

day would now be observed as “Metro Monday”, with ministers, senior officers and government employees encouraged to use Metro and public transport. To reduce peak-hour congestion, Delhi government offices will function from 10:30 am to 7 pm, while Municipal Corporation of Delhi offices will operate from 8:30 am to 5 pm.

The Chief Minister appealed to residents to voluntarily observe one “No Vehicle Day” every week and announced that the Delhi Government would not purchase new petrol, diesel, CNG or hybrid vehicles for six months.

Employees from Grade-1 to Grade-8 spending at least

HIGHLIGHTS

- » To reduce peak-hour congestion, Delhi govt offices will function from 10:30 am to 7 pm, while MCD offices will operate from 8:30 am to 5 pm
- » The Chief Minister appealed to residents to voluntarily observe one ‘No Vehicle Day’ every week

25 per cent of their transport allowance on Metro or public transport will receive an additional 10 per cent incentive.

The government has also prepared a special route plan for 58 feeder buses connecting 29 government colonies to nearby Metro stations. Logistics and freight companies will be encouraged to shift goods transport from trucks to railways to reduce diesel consumption.

Gupta further announced a 20 per cent cut in domestic travel expenditure, while half of all official meetings will now be conducted online. Ministers and officials will avoid official foreign visits for one year, several scheduled foreign

programmes have been cancelled and large government events will remain restricted for three months. Universities, colleges and courts have also been encouraged to maximise online classes, meetings and virtual hearings.

Promoting the “Vocal for Local” initiative, the CM announced that malls and supermarkets in Delhi would soon feature dedicated “Made in India” sections and exhibitions. The government will release a verified list of Indian electronic and domestic products, while official procurement will prioritise Indian-made goods.

As part of energy-saving measures, air conditioners in government offices will be maintained between 24 and 26 degrees Celsius, with sensors and master switches installed to prevent unnecessary electricity use. Gupta said the campaign would involve schools, colleges, RWAs, women’s groups, universities and corporate organisations, with citizens encouraged to pledge fuel conservation, public transport use and reduced wasteful consumption. “Every citizen has an opportunity to serve the nation, small efforts will become India’s greatest strength,” she said.

L-G and CM urge students to link edu with nation-building

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday attended the 14th annual convocation ceremony of Dr. B. R. Ambedkar University Delhi, where students were urged to view education as a responsibility towards society and nation-building.

Addressing the gathering, Sandhu said, “A degree is not just an academic achievement but a commitment to society.” He said the university had established a distinct identity in social sciences, humanities and public engagement over the last 17 years.

Highlighting the changing global landscape, he said India’s greatest strength lies in its youth population and urged students to embrace innovation, entrepreneurship and multidisciplinary learning. “Education today must remain closely linked with society, innovation and the evolving needs of the future,” he added.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta congratulated graduating students and described the convocation as “not only about receiving degrees, but also about embracing new responsibilities towards society and the nation.” She noted that the university, which began with only 19 students, now has over 6,000 students.



KEY POINTS

- » Highlighting the changing global landscape, he said India’s greatest strength lies in its youth population and urged students to embrace innovation, entrepreneurship and multidisciplinary learning
- » ‘Education today must remain closely linked with society, innovation and the evolving needs’
- » Small responsible efforts by youth will lead to a big transformation: Sood

“Ambedkar University is emerging as a centre of social consciousness and excellence inspired by Babasaheb’s

ideals,” she said. Referring to Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s public appeals on resource conservation and self-reliance, Gupta said small nation-first efforts by citizens would strengthen the country’s economy and help realise the vision of a developed India by 2047.

Education Minister Ashish Sood said education remains the most powerful force for transforming individuals and nations. Stressing responsible citizenship and continuous learning, he said, “Small responsible efforts by youth will lead to a big transformation in building a developed India.” The ceremony began with an NCC guard of honour, while degrees were awarded to undergraduate, postgraduate and PhD students across disciplines.

Mayor takes Metro to office, urges citizens to embrace public transport

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Mayor Pravesh Wahi on Thursday travelled to his office by Metro and e-rickshaw, advocating greater use of public transportation to address fuel wastage, air pollution and traffic congestion in the Capital.

Beginning his commute on the Delhi Metro and later taking an e-rickshaw from New Delhi Metro Station, the Mayor interacted with passengers during the journey and highlighted the environmental and economic benefits of using public transport. According



to officials, the initiative was aimed at encouraging citizens to reduce dependence on private vehicles and adopt more sustainable modes of travel.

Wahi said the move was inspired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s appeal to citizens to increasingly use public transportation in

daily life. He added that Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and several ministers of the Delhi government have also been using public transport to spread awareness about fuel conservation and environmental protection.

The Mayor said collective participation by citizens

could significantly reduce traffic congestion and improve Delhi’s air quality. He also noted that the Municipal Corporation of Delhi has issued an advisory encouraging its officers and employees to use public transport and opt for carpooling wherever possible.

Passengers travelling with the Mayor welcomed the initiative, describing it as a positive example set by a public representative. Civic officials said such efforts could help build greater public awareness around sustainable urban mobility and responsible fuel consumption.

‘New DPCC team will strengthen Cong in city’



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Congress chief Devender Yadav on Thursday said the newly appointed members of DPCC after a 14-year gap would carry both responsibility and accountability to strengthen the organisation in the national capital.

Addressing the newly-appointed vice presidents and general secretaries at Rajiv Bhawan, Yadav said the new team represented a mix of experienced leaders, youth, women, minorities, backward classes and Dalits aimed at rebuilding the party’s base in Delhi. He further said responsibility must go hand in hand with accountability and urged leaders to actively coordinate with frontal organisations, departments and cells to build a strong booth-level network across the capital.

“There was indeed a long interval, but a very good committee has been created, which includes youth, women, minorities and experienced members,” he said, expressing confidence that the new office-bearers would work harder to “win the hearts of the people of Delhi”. The Delhi Pradesh Congress Committee chief added that the party had already strengthened its organisational structure through the appointment of district and block presidents, observers and formation of ‘mandalams’ and sectors.

DDA announces free access for joggers, walkers at select parks

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Development Authority has announced free entry for morning walkers at several ticketed parks, green spaces and heritage sites across the Capital till 10 a.m., in a move aimed at encouraging outdoor fitness activities and wider public participation in healthy lifestyles.

The decision was taken following directions issued by Delhi Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu as part of efforts aligned with Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s Fit India Movement initiative.

According to officials, the waiver will apply to popular public spaces currently

“Move was intended to provide relief to morning walkers, joggers and fitness enthusiasts while promoting a culture of health”

charging entry fees, including Mehrauli Archaeological Park, Baansera, Asita, Kranti Udhyan, Vatika, Atal Sadbhavana Park, Vasudev Ghat, Vaishnavi Park and the DDA Green area in Dwarka Sector 16-D.

The initiative will also cover Amrut Bio-Diversity Park, Lala Hardayal Park in Jasola and

Smriti Van.

Officials said the move was intended to provide relief to morning walkers, joggers and fitness enthusiasts while promoting a broader culture of health and well-being in the city. They added that all other DDA parks already remain open to the public free of cost.

The DDA stated that it currently manages more than 16,000 acres of green assets across Delhi, including over 700 parks, biodiversity zones, neighbourhood gardens and city forests.

These spaces, officials said, play a significant role in maintaining ecological balance and ensuring accessible recreational spaces for residents across the Capital.

NDMC unveils green mobility measures

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council on Thursday announced a series of sustainability-focused initiatives, including concessions for electric vehicles, shuttle bus services for employees and restrictions on the purchase of fuel-based vehicles, as part of efforts to promote environmentally responsible governance in the Capital.

Chairing a high-level meeting at Palika Kendra, NDMC Vice-Chairperson Kuljeet Singh Chahal said the measures were inspired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s

Among the key announcements was a 50 per cent concession in parking charges for electric vehicles at NDMC parkings

vision for sustainable development and aligned with appeals made by Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta.

Among the key announcements was a 50 per cent concession in parking charges for electric vehicles at NDMC-managed parking facilities from next week. The civic body also decided not to procure any new petrol, diesel or CNG vehicles for one year, signalling a shift towards cleaner

mobility solutions.

To reduce fuel consumption and traffic congestion, NDMC will begin shuttle bus services for employees from Friday, initially covering four residential colonies including Sarojini Nagar, Laxmibai Nagar and Chanakyapuri. Officials said the network would later be expanded to 14 locations with the deployment of 16 buses.

The civic body further directed that all officers and

Heads of Departments use public transport every Monday, while shared vehicles would be utilised for official inspections and field visits. Greater use of bicycles and e-mobility options will also be encouraged.

NDMC said online meetings, video conferencing and selective work-from-home arrangements for employees would be promoted to minimise travel and improve energy efficiency. Awareness campaigns involving Resident Welfare Associations and market bodies are also planned to encourage sustainable living practices across NDMC areas.

CM, L-G reduce convoy size by 60%

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has reduced her official convoy size by around 60 per cent, with the carcade now comprising only four vehicles, including two electric vehicles (EVs), as part of a series of fuel-saving measures amid the ongoing conflict in West Asia.

Officials said both Gupta and Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu used EVs on Thursday while operating with reduced security convoys. The measures follow Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s appeal to citizens to spend wisely and conserve fuel in view of the international situation.

In a post on X, Sandhu said he had once again experienced “the pulse of the city” through

the Delhi Metro, describing it as an efficient and accessible mode of transport connecting millions every day.

“In my recent travels, I have found it to be the most efficient way to navigate our city while contributing to a sustainable environment,” he said.

The lieutenant governor also urged people to adopt public transport, carpooling and electric vehicles wherever possible, saying such collective efforts could strengthen energy security and help build a greener and cleaner Delhi for future generations.

Earlier today, the chief minister travelled to the 14th convocation ceremony of Dr B R Ambedkar University with minimal security arrangements and in an electric vehicle, according to a statement.

Gupta said her convoy

would now largely be restricted to four vehicles, out of which two will be EVs.

Responding to criticism from the Opposition over political convoys, the chief minister said opposition parties had earlier demanded that the government implement such measures on its own first.

“We have done exactly that today. But will opposition leaders now have the courage to step out on the roads after giving up their attachment to luxury?” she asked. Announcing the steps earlier in the day, Gupta said all Delhi government offices would follow work from home (WFH) two days a week, while private establishments would also be requested to adopt the practice.

She said all ministers, officers and she herself would commute by Metro every Monday.

‘Delhi universities should become vehicles of behavioural change’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu has asked higher educational institutions to strengthen linkages between academia, society, government and industry, while focusing research and outreach efforts on urban challenges such as pollution, water scarcity, traffic congestion and mental health, officials said on Thursday.

Chairing an interactive agenda-setting meeting with vice-chancellors and directors of universities and institutions of higher learning under the Delhi government, the L-G stressed the need to skill students and make graduates more employable and entrepreneurial, officials added.

Sandhu, who is also the chancellor of these institutions, advised universities to sensitise students towards measures such as reducing fossil fuel consumption through greater use of public transport and car pooling.

Officials said the L-G suggested that the nearly three lakh students enrolled in these institutions could act as ambassadors of behavioural change by influencing their families, peers and social circles.

Officials of universities highlighted, “He also called for greater student participation in issues such as women’s safety, traffic decongestion, environmental sustainability, water conservation, groundwater recharge and waste management.”

“The universities and institutions could, and should, become vehicles of Delhi Behavioural Change Mission,” officials quoted the L-G as saying.

STRESSES FASTER GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL

Dy Mayor Pant directs MCD officials to strengthen online civic service delivery

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi on Thursday reviewed the functioning of its Information Technology Department, with Deputy Mayor Monica Pant directing officials to make online civic services more accessible, transparent and citizen-friendly.

Chairing a review meeting attended by senior IT officials, including DC IT Anshul Sirohi, Dr. Pant assessed the progress of ongoing digital projects and emphasised the need to simplify online platforms so that residents can easily access civic services from their homes.

According to officials, the Deputy Mayor stressed that technology-driven governance was essential for improving efficiency and ensuring



accountability in municipal administration. She directed the department to continuously strengthen digital systems to facilitate faster grievance redressal and improve the responsiveness of civic services.

A significant portion of the meeting focused on increasing public awareness of the Corporation’s 311 App, which allows citizens to register civic complaints and monitor their res-

“Officials to undertake extensive outreach campaigns through social media platforms and other public communication channels”

olution status online. Dr. Pant instructed officials to undertake extensive outreach campaigns through social media platforms and other public communication channels to encourage greater use of the application.

She noted that many residents were still unaware of the range of services available through the app and said wider adoption of digital griev-

ance mechanisms could help streamline communication between citizens and the Corporation. Officials were also asked to ensure that complaints received through the platform are addressed in a timely manner. The Deputy Mayor reiterated that the civic body’s broader objective was to provide transparent and technology-enabled public services. She said the IT Department played a crucial role in achieving this vision and directed officials to ensure timely execution of projects alongside continuous improvement in citizen-centric services.

The review comes amid the Corporation’s broader efforts to expand digital governance initiatives and reduce dependency on physical visits to civic offices for routine public services.

Modi, Lavrov discuss Ukraine, West Asia, push for diplomatic solutions

Continued from Page 1

Resolution of conflicts,” he wrote. According to the Prime Minister’s Office, Lavrov briefed Modi on developments in bilateral cooperation since their leaders last met at the 23rd India-Russia Annual Summit in December 2025. Modi asked Lavrov to convey his warm greetings to President Vladimir Putin.

It was at the ministerial sessions, however, that India’s concerns about the deteriorating global order were stated most directly. Opening the conclave, Jaishankar told fellow foreign ministers that the world is not witnessing a set of isolated crises but rather “a convergence of challenges testing the resilience of multilateral systems.” The situation in West Asia, he said, merits particular attention. “Continuing tensions, risks to maritime traffic, and disruptions to energy infrastructure highlight the fragility of the situation,” he said, stressing the importance of safe and unimpeded maritime flows through the Strait of Hormuz and the Red Sea, which he described as vital for global economic wellbeing.

The conflict in Gaza drew sharp remarks from Jaishankar, who cited its “grave humanitarian implications” and called for a sustained ceasefire, humanitarian access, and a credible pathway toward durable peace. “India supports a two-state solution where the Palestine issue is concerned,” he said. He also

flagged concerns over Lebanon, Syria, Sudan, Yemen, and Libya, calling for sustained international engagement and coordinated diplomatic action on each.

The minister did not confine his remarks to active conflicts. He offered a broader warning about what he described as the cumulative toll on the developing world. “Stability cannot be selective, and peace cannot be piecemeal,” he said, noting that the combined pressures on energy, food and fertiliser security, supply chain disruptions, inflationary trends, and constrained growth prospects are hitting emerging markets and developing nations hardest.

On the question of unilateral coercive measures, Jaishankar was pointed in his criticism, declining to name specific nations while making the target of his remarks unmistakable. “Such measures disproportionately affect developing countries. These unjustifiable measures cannot substitute dialogue, nor can pressure replace diplomacy,” he said, adding that the resort to sanctions inconsistent with international law and the UN Charter represents an escalating problem that BRICS must collectively address.

India’s readiness to play a constructive role was placed on record. “India stands ready to contribute constructively to de-escalation efforts and to support initiatives aimed at restoring stability,” Jaishankar said, while framing India’s position around a set of principles:

respect for sovereignty and territorial integrity, protection of civilians, adherence to international law, and avoidance of targeting public infrastructure. “Dialogue and diplomacy are the only means to resolve disputes,” he said.

The conclave was not without its own internal tensions. It is learnt that heated exchanges broke out between Iranian Foreign Minister Araghchi and UAE Minister of State for Foreign Affairs Khalifa Shaheen Al Marar during one of the two sessions, with Lavrov stepping in to cool tensions. Iran and the UAE have been locked in a public dispute over Iran’s alleged attacks on Emirati energy infrastructure, a standoff that has prevented BRICS from producing a consensus statement on the West Asia crisis.

In his own remarks to the gathering, Araghchi described Iran as a victim of “illegal expansionism and warmongering,” calling on BRICS members and the broader international community to “explicitly condemn violations of international law by the United States and Israel, including their illegal aggression against Iran.” He urged the bloc to resist what he characterised as Western hegemony. Jaishankar, in what appeared to be a response to the friction between newer members, noted that it is “essential for the smooth advancement of BRICS that later members fully appreciate and subscribe to the BRICS’ consensus on various important issues.”

The grouping, originally comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa, expanded in 2024 to include Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and the UAE, with Indonesia joining in 2025. The expanded bloc now represents approximately 49.5 per cent of the global population, around 40 per cent of global GDP, and roughly 26 per cent of global trade.

Jaishankar also used the platform to call for reform of the United Nations Security Council. “With each passing day, the case for reformed multilateralism only gets stronger. This includes the reform of the UN Security Council in both the permanent and non-permanent categories. Continued delay comes at a high cost,” he said. He additionally flagged the need to bridge the digital divide, warning that technological advancements raise concerns about trust, transparency, and equitable access, and said climate action must go hand in hand with climate justice, backed by credible commitments and accessible financing.

On terrorism, Jaishankar maintained that there can be no justification for it in any form. “Cross-border terrorism violates the basic principles of international relations. Zero tolerance must remain an uncompromising and universal norm,” he said.

The foreign ministers’ meeting is being held ahead of the BRICS annual summit, scheduled in India for September.

BRICS FOREIGN MINISTERS’ MEETING

S Jaishankar calls for zero tolerance against terrorism

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: Delivering his remarks at the ongoing two-day BRICS Foreign Ministers’ Meeting being held in New Delhi, External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar, on Thursday, made it emphatically clear that terrorism in any form had absolutely “no justification” and cross-border terrorism violates “basic principles of international relations.” Highlighting India’s stance on the matter, Jaishankar went ahead to state that zero tolerance should be the norm when it comes to terrorism.

Speaking to his counterparts on the first day of the two-day ministerial meet, Jaishankar expressed concern over the declining efficiency of the multilateral institutions, especially the UN, and once again reiterated India’s call for reforms within the UN Security Council.

“With each passing day, the case for reform of the multilateral system becomes even more compelling. Delay will come with a high cost,” Jaishankar remarked.



EAM S Jaishankar interacts with Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov during the BRICS Foreign Ministers’ Meeting, in New Delhi, Thursday, May 14, 2026. Vice Minister of Foreign Affairs of Saudi Arabia Waleed A Elkhareiji, centre, is also seen PTI

urged the parties involved to follow international norms and ensure the safety of civilians and refrain from targeting the civilian infrastructure of their respective countries. He stated that India was ready to offer its assistance “in de-escalation efforts” for achieving stability in such nations.

Concerning the humanitarian situation in Gaza, the minister highlighted the importance of the crisis as “carrying grave humanitarian implications” and stressed India’s commitment to “a lasting cease-fire, humanitarian access, and a realistic path forward towards a sustainable and peaceful resolution.” He further emphasised India’s consistent stance on the Palestine question in favour of a two-state solution.

While addressing other pressing issues, the topic of new technologies and the environment, the External Affairs Minister brought up concerns pertaining to rapid developments in technology, which have been instrumental but at the same time pose questions regarding “trust, transparency and equitable access.”

From Page 1

WPI inflation spikes

Core wholesale inflation, which excludes food and fuel, rose to 5 per cent year-on-year, led by higher prices of manufactured goods such as metals, chemicals and textiles. Inflation in manufactured products stood at 4.62 per cent, up from 3.39 per cent in the previous month.

Food inflation remained relatively stable at 1.98 per cent in April compared to 1.90 per cent in March, while inflation in non-food articles increased to 12.18 per cent from 11.5 per cent.

The commerce and industry ministry said the positive inflation rate was “primarily due to an increase in prices of mineral oils, crude petroleum and natural gas, basic metals, other manufacturing and non-food articles.”

Within the fuel category, petrol inflation rose to 32.40 per cent, diesel to 25.19 per cent and LPG to 10.92 per cent.

Despite a 50 per cent rise in global crude oil prices, retail fuel and domestic LPG rates have largely remained unchanged, helping keep consumer inflation at 3.48 per cent in April, though commercial LPG prices have been raised.

Phase 3

The poll body said the schedule for Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir, and Ladakh will be declared later due to weather constraints in snow-bound regions. Once phase 3 is completed, the revision exercise will have covered the entire country except these areas.

Officials noted that the timing of the exercise has been aligned with the ongoing house listing phase of the Census to optimise the use of field machinery.

The Commission also released a timeline for the publication of final electoral rolls. Odisha, Sikkim, Mizoram and Manipur will see their updated rolls published on September 6, while Tripura will be the last, on December 23. The final rolls for Delhi, along with Karnataka, Meghalaya, Maharashtra and Jharkhand, are scheduled for release on October 7.

The Special Intensive Revision has already been carried out in several states and Union Territories, including Bihar, West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Puducherry, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Chhattisgarh, Goa, Andaman and Nicobar Islands and Lakshadweep. A separate special revision was conducted in Assam.

Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar urged voters to take part in the process. “I appeal to all electors to enthusiastically participate in phase 3 of the SIR and fill their enumeration forms. SIR is being conducted with the objective to ensure that only eligible voters to be included in the electoral roll and no ineligible names to be included,” he said.

Data from the previous phase showed that electoral rolls across nine states and three Union Territories were reduced by 10.2 per cent, with more than 60 lakh deceased voters removed. The voter base declined from over 50.99 crore to 45.81 crore, reflecting a reduction of more than 5.18 crore names.

Storms, lightning

18, followed by Prayagraj with 17 deaths, Mirzapur 15 and Fatehpur 10. Deaths were also reported from districts including Unnao, Badaun, Bareilly, Sitapur, Rae Bareilly and Chandauli, largely due to collapsing structures, falling trees and lightning strikes.

Narendra N. Srivastava, an official with the Relief and Revenue Department, said emergency teams had been deployed in all affected districts.

“District administrations have been instructed to provide immediate assistance to affected families and ensure compensation reaches them without delay,” Srivastava said. “Police, disaster response teams and local authorities are continuously monitoring vulnerable areas and restoring damaged infrastructure.”

Officials said preliminary assessments indicated extensive losses to houses, standing crops and electricity systems, particularly in rural regions.

Residents in Prayagraj recounted scenes of chaos as strong winds swept through residential areas.

“The storm came suddenly and within minutes the entire sky turned dark,” said Ram Kishore, a resident of Phulpur in Prayagraj district. “Tin roofs were flying and trees kept falling throughout the evening.”

In Bhadohi district, Savitri Devi said her family escaped moments before their mud house partially collapsed.

“We ran outside when the walls started shaking because of the wind,” she said. “The roof collapsed shortly after. We spent the night at a relative’s house.”

Police and disaster response personnel used cranes and chainsaws to remove uprooted trees from highways and railway tracks in multiple districts.

“We received continuous distress calls related to fallen trees, damaged houses and snapped electricity lines,” a senior police officer in Fatehpur said. “Teams worked through the night to clear roads and shift injured people to hospitals.”

Rail movement on the Delhi-Howrah route was disrupted for nearly 90 minutes after a tree fell on overhead electric lines in Fatehpur district. Railway officials said around 22 trains passing through Kanpur were affected before services resumed later in the evening.

Train operations on the Prayagraj-Jaunpur route were also suspended temporarily after a large tree fell across tracks between Tharwai and Sarai Chandi stations.

“Our priority was passenger safety,” a railway official in Prayagraj said. “Technical teams restored the overhead systems and cleared the tracks despite difficult weather conditions.”

While the storm brought temporary relief from intense heat in some parts of the state, southern districts including Bundelkhand continued to reel under severe temperatures.

According to the Regional Meteorological Centre in Lucknow, Banda recorded the highest temperature in the state at 45.4 degrees Celsius, followed by Jhansi at 44.5 degrees Celsius and Prayagraj at 43.5 degrees Celsius. Senior meteorologist Atul Kumar Singh said temperatures were likely to rise again from Thursday onward.

Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath directed officials to complete relief work within 24 hours and ensure compensation for victims affected by the unseasonal storms and lightning strikes.

In a statement, Adityanath expressed condolences to the bereaved families and instructed district administrations to provide immediate medical aid, food and shelter to affected residents.

Cong names

The decision was announced here at a press conference by AICC in-charge of Kerala Deepa Dasmuni and the party’s central observers for the state Ajay Maken and Mukul Wasnik, as well as Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh.

“Based on all the discussions, it has been decided that VD Satheesan be appointed as the leader of the CLP,” Dasmuni told reporters. The three main contenders for the post of chief minister were Satheesan, KC Venugopal and Ramesh Chennithala.

“The Congress Legislature Party had met in Thiruvananthapuram on May 7, 2026 and had unanimously resolved to authorise Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge to appoint the new leader of the CLP in the state,” Dasmuni said.

Accordingly, the Congress president has held extensive discussions with Chairperson of the Congress Parliamentary Party Sonia Gandhi, Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, AICC observers who had met with the newly-elected MLAs and many other leaders, including MPs, and former Kerala Pradesh Congress Committee chiefs, she said.

Dasmunshi also brushed aside any talk of divisions within the party and said all were united.

Satheesan and other ministers will be sworn in at a ceremony in Thiruvananthapuram on May 18. Satheesan said that a decision on other ministers will be finalised soon and discussions will begin on Friday.

A decision on the next Kerala chief minister had been pending since May 4 when the Congress-led UDF won 102 seats out of the 140, which is more than a two-thirds majority.

The party’s central leadership held wider consultations as the uncertainty continued for days even after party observers Maken and Wasnik met Congress MLAs and gathered their views. The party leadership had also held discussions with the three main

contenders for the post and Kerala Pradesh Congress Committee chief Sunny Joseph.

The Congress has 63 MLAs in the 140-member Kerala Assembly. Its allies Indian Union Muslim League (IUML) has 22, Kerala Congress (KEC) has eight and the Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) three.

driver and conductor arrested

stand in Saraswati Vihar. As per her statement, she approached a man standing at the door of a sleeper bus to ask for the time. She alleged that she was forcibly pulled inside the vehicle, after which the bus was driven towards Nangloi.

Police sources said the bus was later stationed near the Nangloi Metro station, where both the driver and conductor allegedly raped her in turn. The woman, who is married and has three children, told investigators that she was assaulted for an extended period before being dumped out of the vehicle.

The police received a PCR call regarding the incident at around 4.45 am on May 12. Initially handled by Nangloi police, the case was subsequently transferred to Rani Bagh police station. Deputy Commissioner of Police (Outer) Vikram Singh said, “The victim’s statement was recorded immediately and an FIR registered without delay.”

The FIR was lodged under sections 64(1) (rape), 70(1) (gang rape) and 3(5) (common intention) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita on May 12. Officials said the woman was provided immediate assistance, medically examined, and her statement recorded soon after she approached the police.

Multiple police teams were formed to trace the accused. One of the men was arrested soon after the FIR was registered, while the second was apprehended within four hours. Both were produced before a court and sent to judicial custody.

Investigators said they are reconstructing the sequence of events and mapping the route taken by the bus from the point where the woman was allegedly dragged inside. CCTV footage from the surrounding areas is being analysed to establish movement patterns and determine whether any other passengers were present during the incident.

Forensic teams have been deployed to collect evidence from the bus, and officials said medical and forensic reports will be examined closely. Police are also probing whether the bus was operational at the time and if it had automatic doors.

Sahil Malhotra, owner of the bus service, said he cooperated with the police after being informed about the incident. He stated that the driver had been employed with him for around one and a half years and had no prior criminal record.

The victim’s husband told reporters that she sustained minor injuries on her face and hands during the assault. “We got to know she was dragged into the bus and raped by two men. The police have supported us fully,” he said, adding that the family is seeking strict punishment for the accused.

The incident has drawn sharp reactions from political leaders. Former Delhi chief minister Arvind Kejriwal said on social media, “We learned nothing from Nirbhaya. This incident is a stain on the entire society.” Leaders of the Aam Aadmi Party also condemned the assault, calling it a matter of grave concern.

The case comes against the backdrop of data from the National Crime Records Bureau, which reported that Delhi recorded 13,396 crimes against women in 2024, the highest among 19 metropolitan cities. Of these, 1,058 were rape cases.

Police said further investigation is ongoing and assured that efforts are being made to ensure a strong case and a speedy trial.

Indian cargo

According to Mukesh Mangal, Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, all crew members were rescued by the Oman Coast Guard and taken to Dibba port. “The crew is reported to be safe, and necessary formalities with the local authorities have been completed,” he said, adding that arrangements are being made to bring them back to India.

The incident comes against the backdrop of heightened tensions in the region following the out-

break of hostilities between the United States and Iran on February 28. At least two other Indian-flagged ships have been targeted since the conflict began, amid an increasingly fragile security situation in the Strait of Hormuz.

Despite the risks, maritime traffic linked to India has continued. Two India-bound liquefied petroleum gas tankers, Symi and NV Sunshine, crossed the strategic waterway this week, carrying 19,965 tonnes and 46,427 tonnes of LPG respectively. Both cargoes belong to Indian Oil Corporation and are expected to arrive at Kandla on May 16 and New Mangalore on May 18.

Officials said 13 Indian-flagged vessels, including 12 LPG tankers and one crude oil tanker, have transited the strait since early March, while at least 12 Indian ships remain stranded in the Gulf along with several foreign vessels carrying cargo for India.

Xi hails US-China

Xi and Trump will meet again Friday morning and the leaders will sit for tea and a diplomatic lunch before the US president departs for Washington.

According to a PTI report, Xi warned his US counterpart that mishandling the Taiwan issue could trigger “clashes and even conflicts” between the two countries, as the two leaders held wide-ranging talks on the Iran war, energy security and trade.

After concluding the first round of talks, which lasted for around two hours, Trump invited Xi and his wife to the White House on September 24, as both leaders agreed that the Strait of Hormuz must remain open to support the free flow of energy, according to a readout of their meeting issued by the White House.

“I have agreed with President Trump on a new vision of building a constructive China-US relationship of strategic stability,” Xi said.

Xi said the “new vision” would provide strategic guidance for bilateral relations over the next three years and beyond, and should be welcomed by the people of both countries as well as the international community, official media reported.

He, however, stressed that the Taiwan question remained the most important issue in China-US relations. Later, in his address at a lavish banquet hosted in honour of Trump, Xi said both sides should make relations work.

“We must make it work, and never mess it up,” Xi said, adding that both China and the US stand to gain from cooperation and lose from confrontation. “Our two countries should be partners rather than rivals,” he added.

China regards Taiwan as a renegade province that must be reunified with the mainland. It opposes formal diplomatic ties between Taipei and countries that recognise Beijing. The US, however, has maintained ties with Taiwan and continued supplying arms to the island.

In his remarks at the banquet, Trump said the two sides had positive and constructive conversations.

Noting that the US-China relationship is the most consequential bilateral relationship in the world, Trump said the two countries should strengthen cooperation to create a better future for the world, state-run Xinhua news agency reported.

The building of a constructive China-US relationship of strategic stability should not be a mere slogan, but concrete action taken by both sides toward the same goal, he added. China-US economic ties are mutually beneficial and win-win in nature, Xi said.

On the trade talks, Xi said that the economic and trade teams of the two countries produced “generally balanced and positive outcomes” in the latest round of bilateral trade talks.

Trump termed his meeting with Xi as the “biggest summit ever” to discuss a wide range of issues, including the Iran war and bilateral trade frictions.

This is the first visit to China by a US president in nine years. Trump himself was the last US president to visit China in 2017.

Accompanying Trump on his trip to China are some of America’s top business leaders, such as Nvidia’s Jensen Huang, Tim Cook of Apple, Elon Musk of Tesla and SpaceX, and Larry Fink of BlackRock.

Trump’s visit comes amid growing economic and geopolitical uncertainties arising from conflicts in West Asia and the subsequent global energy shock that has taken a toll, particularly in Asia.

In an interview with NBC News, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio said Trump had raised the Iran issue during talks with Xi but had not sought Beijing’s assistance. “We’re not asking for China’s help. We don’t need their help.”

Rubio said China agreed that Iran should not possess nuclear weapons. He also said that China using force in Taiwan would be “very disruptive for the world.”

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Justice Swarana Sharma

She added that remaining silent in such circumstances would not amount to restraint but could be seen as “surrender before a powerful litigant.”

Justice Sharma further noted that references to her family members in the online campaign crossed a line, stating that her children had no connection to the case. She also termed letters written by Kejriwal, Sisodia and Pathak, announcing a boycott of proceedings after their recusal plea was rejected, as contemptuous.

“Instead of pursuing remedies available in law, a calculated campaign of vilification and intimidation was orchestrated,” she said, adding that the actions went beyond mere disagreement with a judicial order and targeted the institution itself.

Clarifying her position, the judge said she was not recusing herself but transferring the matter to another bench to avoid any perception of personal bias after initiating contempt proceedings. The case will now be placed before the Chief Justice for reassignment.

Appearing for the Central Bureau of Investigation, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta supported the court’s stance and called for a standard procedure to address such situations. He also urged the judge to continue hearing the matter and dismissed allegations concerning her family.

The developments follow a February 27 trial court order discharging Kejriwal, Sisodia and 21 others in the excise policy case, and subsequent events after the rejection of their recusal plea on April 20.

Reacting to the development, Kejriwal said, “Truth has triumphed. Mahatma Gandhi’s Satyagraha has triumphed once again.”

US may drop fraud

According to people familiar with the matter cited by Bloomberg, the US Justice Department is preparing to withdraw the charges, while the US Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) is also moving toward settling a parallel civil fraud case filed in November 2024 against Adani and others. The people spoke on condition of anonymity because the discussions remain confidential.

Ending the cases would be a significant boon to the Adani Group, one of India’s most powerful companies, whose interests range from coal mining to renewable energy and airports. It also clears the decks for the conglomerate to return to international capital markets and resume its aggressive expansion strategy.

While the Justice Department could effectively move to drop the charges with the defendants out of the country, a resolution to the SEC would likely involve a monetary penalty, some of the people said.

In November 2024, the US Attorney’s Office in Brooklyn alleged in a five-count indictment that Adani and other defendants helped drive a \$265 million bribery scheme in India to lock in solar-power contracts. The Adani Group has consistently denied the charges. None of the defendants, including Adani and his nephew Sagar, have appeared in court so far over the charges, and the case has been effectively stalled.

In its case, the Justice Department alleged that Adani and others promised bribes to Indian government officials to win solar energy contracts and concealed the plan as they sought to raise money from US investors.

While the Justice Department prosecution has been stalled with the Adanis not in the US, the SEC case had started to advance in court.

US authorities are moving to resolve the fraud charges against billionaire Gautam Adani, according to people familiar with the matter, and end a criminal case that’s hung over Asia’s richest person for more than a year. The Justice Department may announce that they’re dropping the charges as soon as this week, said the people, who asked not to be identified discussing a confidential matter.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

LEADER SAYS SLANDER BEING SPREAD AGAINST HIM

AIADMK power struggle escalates as rebels move against Palaniswami

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHENNAI: The rift in the AIADMK widened further on Thursday, with the faction opposed to party chief Edappadi K Palaniswami accusing him and his supporting MLAs of “defying” its “whip” regarding the floor test of the TVK government, and sought their disqualification under the anti-defection law.

Hitting back at his rivals, Palaniswami, addressed as EPS, alleged that they were behind minister posts and were spreading slander against him. “They have fallen for the lure of six minister posts and 10 board chiefs,” he said. “It is very painful that those who have betrayed the party are spreading slanderous propaganda about me,” he claimed.

His rival faction, led by senior leaders and former ministers C Ve Shanmugam and SP Velumani, claimed they had the



AIADMK General Secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami during the floor test on Wednesday

PTI

Highlights

- » Hitting back at his rivals, Palaniswami, addressed as EPS, alleged the they were behind minister posts and were spreading slander against him
- » “They have fallen for the lure of six minister posts and 10 board chiefs,” he claimed in a statement

majority of the 47 MLAs the party has.

C Vijayabaskar, appointed as the “whip” of the faction, told reporters that the legislature party is decided based on majority numbers and indicated that his faction enjoyed that. His instruction to vote in favour of the C Joseph Vijay-led TVK government during its confidence vote on Wednesday

was duly communicated to all the AIADMK MLAs through Whatsapp and e-mail, he said.

“Of the 47 MLAs, 25 abided by the instruction. As many as 22 party mlas, including Edappadi Palaniswami, did not comply with the directives issued by me, who is the whip, and went contrary to that. So we have met the Assembly Speaker today and

sought their (pro-Palaniswami MLAs) disqualification under the anti-defection law,” he said. “Majority of MLAs under S P Velumani followed the whip order. So only majority is valid,” he said.

Velumani, citing precedents, said that when a split emerges in a party due to difference of opinion, no decisions can be taken; neither

can someone be appointed or removed from the party posts or the organisation.

“We are clear- (Palaniswami should) convene party General Council to discuss the reasons for the poll defeat. He is the general secretary,” Velumani said.

Further, hitting out at the party chief, he said his actions pertaining to sacking functionaries from party posts and making new appointments were “not valid.”

“Our intent is to strengthen the party. Bring back those who had gone, who had been sacked from party. Why did MGR start the party-- to oppose DMK,” he said. Palaniswami’s decisions regarding removing people from their party positions are not valid and “they continue in their posts,” he added.

The AIADMK chief had removed from party posts. Shanmugam, Velumani and others in the wake of the rift.

‘Will strike back’: Rajnath warns Pak against terrorism

Says India no longer a country that suffers

OUR CORRESPONDENT

JAIPUR: Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Thursday warned Pakistan against terrorism and said India would strike back decisively if provoked again.

Addressing a public gathering at Nagaur’s Merta town after unveiling a statue of Rajput ruler Rao Duda, Singh said Operation Sindoor had sent a strong message to Pakistan.

“Perhaps Pakistan will not dare to look at India with hostility again. But I want to say that if it does, what has not happened till now will happen,” he said. “From the beginning, our policy was not to provoke anyone. But if anyone provokes us, we do not spare them either,” Singh said.

Referring to the Pahalgam terror attack on April 22 last year, he said the terrorists had fired at people based on their religion.

“Indian culture says there



Rajnath Singh addresses a public meeting during the unveiling of a statue of Rajput ruler Rao Duda, at, in Nagaur, Rajasthan

PTI

No border can stop us,” Singh added.

India has adopted a “zero tolerance” policy against terrorism, the defence minister said, citing the surgical strikes in 2016 and Balakot airstrikes in 2019 as examples of India’s changing response strategy.

Speaking at the event, Singh said politics should guide society towards the right path.

Politics in India had “lost its meaning and spirit” over the years, but the Narendra Modi-led government is working to restore it, he said, adding that the country’s politics now is driven by values and is focused on both development and heritage.

On women’s empowerment, the minister said the Centre is committed to the idea, and campaigns like “Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao” and stricter women’s safety laws are indicative of this.

He reiterated the government’s resolve for women’s reservation in the legislature.

Big relief for HAL retirees as Allahabad HC backs higher pension

Rules that cut-off dates cannot extinguish a statutory right to pension

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: In a significant relief to retired employees of Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL), the Allahabad High Court’s Lucknow bench has quashed orders issued by the Regional Provident Fund Commissioner (RPFC) rejecting higher pension claims, paving the way for nearly 400 pensioners in Lucknow to receive enhanced pension benefits.

The court passed the order while hearing petitions filed by retired HAL employees, including writ petitions led by Atul Kapoor and Sunil Kumar Mehrotra. The judgments, delivered are being viewed as a major legal breakthrough for pensioners seeking benefits under the Employees’ Pension Scheme (EPS), 1995.

The dispute centered on the rejection of joint option forms submitted by pensioners for higher pension based on actual salary. The Employees’ Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) had argued that pensionable salary should be capped at Rs 6,500 in accordance with HAL trust rules.

The petitioners contended that both employees and the employer had already contributed provident fund amounts on actual salaries and therefore pension calculations should also be based on full salary rather than the capped amount. Justice Prakash Singh, while allowing the petitions, observed that EPS-1995 is a beneficial statutory scheme that overrides internal trust regulations.

The court held that beneficial amendments applicable to employees cannot be denied merely because trust rules were not formally amended. It further ruled that cut-off dates cannot extinguish a statutory right to higher pension.

The judgment also relied on principles laid down earlier by the Supreme Court in the R.C. Gupta and Sunil Kumar B. cases concerning higher pen-



Key Points

- » The dispute centered on the rejection of joint option forms submitted by pensioners for higher pension based on actual salary
- » The EPFO had argued that pensionable salary should be capped at Rs 6,500 in accordance with HAL trust rules

sion entitlement.

Atul Kapoor, former president of HAL Employees Association, Lucknow, described the ruling as a milestone for pensioners across the country.

“The judiciary has made it clear that statutory rights cannot be overridden by internal administrative rules,” Kapoor said. “This judgment has strengthened the movement for higher pension and given hope to thousands of retired employees.”

After TN debacle, Stalin takes the fall for DMK’s loss

CHENNAI: DMK President MK Stalin on Thursday said he would take full responsibility for the party’s defeat in the April 23 Tamil Nadu Assembly elections.

He announced that a panel would be constituted to evaluate the reasons for the poll defeat and submit a report within 20 days.

Stalin also took a swipe at the AIADMK, saying his party was mature enough not to lodge its legislators in a resort.

His veiled reference was aimed at the AIADMK, which lodged its newly elected MLAs at a resort in Puducherry following the May 4 Assembly election results, in which no single party secured the required 118 seats to form the government on its own.

Addressing the party’s dis-



MK Stalin during a meeting of the party’s district secretaries on Thursday

PTI

trict secretaries at Anna Arivalayam, the DMK headquarters here, Stalin said no party had secured a majority on its own to form the government.

“The C Joseph Vijay-led government is now in power due to the support of coalition partners. They formed the government with the backing of the Left parties, VCK and

IUML,” the former CM said, referring to the unconditional support extended by the allies to the TVK. “Past election results showed that whenever we lost power, we won only a very small number of seats. This time, we won 59 seats. If we add the seats secured by our allies, the tally rises to 73.”

Pointing out that success

CBI arrests key accused in Rs 72 cr cyber fraud

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The CBI has arrested the key accused in a major transnational cyber-enabled financial fraud case involving illegal call centres operating from India and defrauding US nationals of nearly US\$ 8.5 million (around Rs 72 crore).

The arrested accused has been identified as Lakhan Jaiprakash Jagwani, who was apprehended in Delhi on Wednesday after remaining absconding since the registration of the case. According to

the CBI, the case was registered on December 9, 2025, against multiple accused persons for allegedly running a large-scale cyber fraud syndicate through illegal call centres based in New Delhi, Noida and other locations in India since September 2022.

Investigators alleged that the accused persons, acting in conspiracy with each other and unidentified associates, impersonated officials of US government agencies including the Drug Enforcement Administration (DEA), Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI).

Emotions run high as Prateek Yadav is cremated in Lucknow

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Prateek Yadav, younger brother of Akhilesh Yadav, was cremated at Baikunth Dham in Lucknow on Thursday in the presence of family members, senior leaders and supporters of

the Samajwadi Party.

The last rites were performed by Arvind Singh Bisht, father of Aparna Yadav and father-in-law of Prateek Yadav, who lit the funeral pyre. Akhilesh Yadav and his uncle Shivpal Singh Yadav were present during the cremation along with

Prateek’s two daughters.

Family members and supporters turned emotional during the funeral proceedings. Shivpal Singh Yadav was seen consoling the two daughters amid the sombre atmosphere at the cremation ground.



NARESH BISWANI

GHAZIABAD: Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Thursday conferred the President’s Colour on the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) at a ceremony held in Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh, and said India is steadily moving towards the goal of “zero casualty” in disaster management through improved preparedness, forecasting and community participation.

Shah stated the award reflects more than just the bravery and work of the NDRF - it highlights efforts by state-level teams, village councils, youth groups like NCC and NSS, along with countless local

responders nationwide. Their reliability, shaped by the guiding phrase “Service in Crisis, Always Everywhere,” has positioned them as figures people turn to when calamities strike.

More than two decades of effort by the NDRF have led to effective responses during floods, quakes, storms, and similar crises. Over one hundred fifty thousand lives were saved through these operations.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused (1) **Arti Tomar W/o Ashwani Tomar (2) Ashwani Tomar S/o Rajender Tomar R/o House No. 30/19, Road No. 20, West Patel Nagar, New Delhi also at 25/22, 3rd Floor, West Patel Nagar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 411/2017 U/S 420/506/120B/34 IPC, PS Prasad Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused (1) **Arti Tomar (2) Ashwani Tomar** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said (1) **Arti Tomar (2) Ashwani Tomar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused (1) **Arti Tomar (2) Ashwani Tomar of FIR No. 411/2017 U/S 420/506/120B/34 IPC, PS Prasad Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **11.08.2026 at 10:00 am**

By Order,
Sh. Karanbir Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
Central, Room No. 26
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/5807/CD/2026(Court Matter)

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: “UJJWAL”, Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763803, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Letter No: 412 **Tender Notice** Date: 14/05/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites sealed tender from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No: 05 & 06/EE(Civil)/MB-II/Chinyalisaur/2026-27

1. Name of work: Annual operation and maintenance of 120 KLD capacity MBR technology based STP plant at MB-II, Chinyalisaur, Uttarkashi.

2. Name of work: Repair and treatment of roof dampness in AP & BP type quarters at Shaktipuram Colony, MB-II, Chinyalisaur, Uttarkashi.

1. Estimated Cost: Rs. 12,00,373.00 (excluding GST)

2. Estimated Cost: Rs. 19,77,689.00 (excluding GST)

Date of availability of bid document on website: 14.05.2026 from 5:00PM

Last date for submission of tender: 06.06.2026 upto 11:00AM

For fuller & further detail, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be download from the Nigam’s website “www.ujvn.com”

Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur.

“AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY”

WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
SCO 74-75, BANK SQUARE, SECTOR 17-B, CHANDIGARH: 160017
Web: www.pswc.in
Notice Inviting Offers
(Reference No. PSWC/Claims/2026-27/01)

Punjab State Warehousing Corporation (PSWC) invites Expression of Interests (EOIs) Offers/Proposals in sealed cover from eligible Insurance Organizations for procurement of insurance cover policy for its food-grain stocks lying in open and covered spaces in flood prone centers during the period of monsoon, on detailed instructions, terms and conditions available on its website i.e. www.pswc.in. Only eligible entities may submit their EOIs offers as per the instructions hosted on www.pswc.in by 29.05.2026.

Closing Date and Time: **Upto 5:00 PM on 29.05.2026**

For details log onto: www.pswc.in

Note: Any corrigendum/s to this Notice shall be published on the website www.pswc.in only.

PR-Advt. No : 1004/12/2026-27/11479 Managing Director

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Mohd. Saad Anees s/o, Mohd. Anees, r/o, 1607, Gali Tajran, Sui Walan, Darya Ganj, Delhi-110002. have change my name from Saad to Mohd. Saad Anees for all purposes, legal and other wise.

I, Anjum Aftab Khan w/o, Mohd. Aftab Khan Sharifi, r/o, 2154, Gali Addan Wali, Pahari Bhojla, Turkman Gate, Delhi-110006. have change my name from Anjum Ali to Anjum Aftab Khan for all purposes, legal and other wise.

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, सिमडेगा।
Email Id- rwsimdegaa@gmail.com

ई-पुनर्निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना (e-Procurement Call) 2nd Call

ई-पुनर्निविदा सूचना संख्या – 18/R/1/2026-27/RWD/SIM दिनांक – 13-05-2026

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी-मुख्यमंत्री ग्राम सड़क योजना (4515)

क्र.सं.	प्रकृष्ट	आईडेंटिफिकेशन संख्या	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख में)	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	निविदा कॉल संख्या
1	जलवेधना	RWD/ SIM/18/02/ 2024-25	मिजुल्पाड़ा में ओझगा-हुरदा आर०डि०ओ पथ से पारलटोली, पाइनटोली, बिडियटोली, गिजराटोली होते हुए ओझगा-हुरदा आर०डि०ओ रोड तक पथ निर्माण कार्य। (ल०-4.950 कि०मी०)	554.475 (पाँच करोड़ चौरान लाख सैतालीस हजार पाँच सौ रुपये मात्र)	11,09,000 (ग्यारह लाख नौ हजार रुपये मात्र)	10,000	18 महीना	द्वितीय

1. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 15-05-2026

2. ई-पुनर्निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय – 08-06-2026 अपराह्न 05:00 बजे तक।

3. ई-पुनर्निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय – 10-06-2026 अपराह्न 11:30 बजे।

4. ई-पुनर्निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का पदनाम एवं पद।

5. ई-पुनर्निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, सिमडेगा।

6. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि विभागीय पत्रांक 3130 अगुा दि० 09-10-2023 के निर्देशानुसार केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।

7. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुगलान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता कॉ बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही निविदादाता की होगी।

8. प्राक्कलित राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है। अग्रघन की राशि परिमाण विपत्र के अनुसार मान्य होगी।

जिस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाइट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग,
कार्य प्रमंडल, सिमडेगा।

PR 379810 (Simdega) 26-27 (D)

'ASPIRANT COMMITS SUICIDE IN UP'

NEET paper leak case: Five remanded in CBI custody, two more held

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The CBI on Thursday secured the custody of five persons arrested in the NEET-UG exam leak case and apprehended two more suspects as officials said the agency is also looking into possible role of any insider in the National Testing Agency (NTA) in the irregularities.

The court which granted CBI the custody of the five accused for seven days said the allegations revealed the role of an "organised gang" involved in leaking and circulating confidential examination papers for monetary gain.

In Uttar Pradesh's Lakhimpur Kheri district, a 21-year-old NEET aspirant hanged himself in his house in Gangotrinagar locality over the cancellation of the exam, his father claimed. This was Mishra's third NEET attempt, and he was highly confident of clearing the exam this time, his father said. Police said no suicide note was recovered from the room where Ritik's body was found hanging.

During the day, protests continued at several parts of the country demanding immediate scrapping of the NTA and the dismissal of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. In Ahmedabad, Pradhan was greeted with black flags by members of the Congress-affiliated National Students Union of India (NSUI) when he arrived at the Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad (IIMA) to chair a coordination forum meeting of IIMS.

The Federation of Resident Doctors' Association (FORDA) wrote to Prime Minister Narendra Modi demanding strict



HIGHLIGHTS

» Protests continued at several parts of the country demanding scrapping of the NTA

» Union Education minister Pradhan was greeted with black flags by NSUI members in Ahmedabad

action against those involved in the paper leak and seeking a shift to a computer-based format for the medical entrance test. The NEET (UG) 2026 exam for admissions in undergraduate medical courses held on May 3 was cancelled by the NTA on Tuesday amid allegations of paper leak. The cancellation of the exam has left over 22 lakh medical aspirants in uncertainty.

Addressing reporters here, BJP national spokesperson Sambit Patra said the government has taken up the NEET paper leak case with "great seriousness and sensitivity" and assured students and parents of strict action against all those involved. "No one will be spared, especially this exam mafia that is attempting to toy with the future of our children. Absolutely no one will be

spared," he asserted.

The CBI, which is probing the case, has arrested two more persons in connection with the paper leak. Dhananjay Lokhande was arrested from Ahilyanagar and Manisha Waghmare from Pune.

The role of several officers of the NTA and other organisations having access to the printing press where NEET UG papers were printed have come under the scanner, officials said. The CBI is focussing on identifying the source of the leak, they said.

According to the CBI investigation so far, the involvement of public servants in the leak could not be ruled out.

During the day, Special CBI judge Ajay Gupta sent the five persons arrested earlier to seven days' CBI custody.

Gupta was hearing a CBI plea to interrogate all the five accused for seven more days in the case to unearth the whole conspiracy. The five arrested - Shubham Khairnar from Nashik, Mangilal Biwal, Vikas Biwal and Dinesh Biwal from Jaipur, and Yash Yadav from Gurugram - were taken into custody by the agency after a transit remand was secured from different states.

SCOPE & AMBIT OF RIGHT TO FREEDOM OF RELIGION

SC reserves order on pleas pertaining to religious discrimination against women

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: A nine-judge Supreme Court bench on Thursday reserved its order on petitions related to discrimination against women at religious places, including Sabarimala temple, and on the ambit and scope of religious freedom practised by multiple faiths.

A constitution bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant heard the matter for 16 days and took note of arguments made by Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, senior advocates C S Vaidyanathan, Abhishek Singhvi, Mukul Rohatgi, Indira Jaising, Neeraj Kishan Kaul and Gopal Sankaranarayanan among others.

The bench also comprised justices B V Nagarathna, M M Sundresh, Ahsanuddin Amanul-lah, Aravind Kumar, Augustine George Masih, Prasanna B Varale, R Mahadevan and Joy-malya Bagchi.



Ahead of the hearing, the Centre had filed written submissions and requested the top court to uphold restriction on the entry of women of menstruating age into the Sabarimala temple. The Union of India said the issue falls squarely within the domain of religious faith and denominational autonomy, and lies beyond the scope of judicial review.

In September 2018, a five-judge constitution bench, by a 4:1 majority verdict, had lifted the ban that prevented women between the age of 10 and 50

The govt said the issue falls squarely within the domain of religious faith... & lies beyond scope of judicial review

from entering the Ayyappa shrine at Sabarimala and held that the centuries-old Hindu religious practice was illegal and unconstitutional.

Later, on November 14, 2019, another five-judge bench headed by the then CJI Ranjan Gogoi, by a majority of 3:2, referred the issue of discrimination against women at various places of worship to a larger bench. The bench had then framed broad issues on freedom across religions, saying they cannot be decided without any facts of the particular case.

Besides the Sabarimala case, the verdict also referred to the larger bench the issues of Muslim women's entry into mosques and dargahs, and the entry of Parsi women, married to non-Parsi men, to the holy fire place of an Agni.

On May 11, 2020, another bench held that its five-judge bench had the power to refer the questions of law to a larger bench for adjudication while exercising its limited power under review jurisdiction in the Sabarimala temple entry case.

On February 16, the top court had said it would commence final hearing in the matter on April 7, which was expected to conclude on April 22. Solicitor General Mehta, appearing for the Centre, had said that he supported the pleas for review of the Sabarimala verdict, which allowed entry of women of all age groups to the hill-top shrine in Kerala.

Gameskraft probe: ED freezes ₹526-cr assets

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has conducted extensive searches against Gameskraft Technologies Pvt. Ltd. and its directors in an alleged online gaming fraud and money laundering case involving suspected user losses of over Rs 1,154 crore. The searches, carried out by the Bengaluru Zonal Office between May 7 and May 13, covered company offices and residences of directors and key employees in Bengaluru and the NCR.

During the operation, the ED froze movable assets worth about Rs 526.49 crore, including bank balances, payment gateway funds, mutual funds, bonds and fixed deposits. The agency also

seized 2.30 kg of bullion, gold and diamond jewellery valued at around Rs 3.5 crore, along with Rs 11 lakh in cash.

According to the ED, the probe arose from multiple FIRs alleging cheating. The agency claimed Gameskraft operated real-money gaming platforms in states where online rummy is banned by allegedly manipulating users' geo-location data.

Investigators further alleged that the company used automated bots to compete against users without disclosure, initially allowing small wins before exposing players to higher-stakes games leading to heavy losses. The ED has arrested company directors Prithvi Raj Singh, Vikas Taneja and Deepak Singh Ahlawat under PMLA.

Hry CM hails BJP's win in local polls

CHANDIGARH: Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday hailed the BJP's victory in the civic body elections and said the people of Haryana have once again expressed their confidence in politics centred on development and good governance. He said people of Haryana have chosen the "triple-engine government" and reaffirmed trust in the development model.

Addressing a felicitation ceremony at the state BJP headquarters in Panchkula organised to honour the newly elected mayors, chairpersons and councillors of the urban local bodies, the chief minister said people have once again rejected the Congress' negative politics in civic body elections.

Haryana BJP president Mohan Lal Kaushik, party's Haryana affairs in-charge



Satish Poonia, ministers Vipul Goel, Ranbir Gangwa, Arvind Sharma and Krishan Kumar Bedi, newly elected Panchkula Mayor Shyam Lal Bansal, Ambala Mayor Akshita Saini and Sonapat Mayor Sonipat Rajiv Jain were among those present on the occasion.

The BJP on Wednesday swept the municipal corporation polls, registering emphatic wins in Panchkula, Ambala and Sonapat. Barring Uklana, where a 23-year-old student won the municipal committee's president post as an independent candidate defeating

Hry: Hooda alleges bias in hirings

CHANDIGARH: Former Haryana Chief Minister Bhupinder Singh Hooda on Thursday accused the BJP government of rampant corruption and discrimination against Haryana's youth.

Addressing a press conference in Rohtak, Hooda claimed BJP leaders themselves admitted during the DISHA Committee meeting that the roads constructed during the Congress regime "remain intact even after 10 years", whereas roads built under their government "do not last even 10 days".

Citing NCRB data, he said an average of nine people die by suicide daily in Haryana due to unemployment, economic insecurity and mental stress. Hooda alleged the government was favouring outside candidates in recruitment drives.

He claimed that in Assistant Professor recruitment for Hindi, 41 of 60 selected general category candidates were from other states.

MPOST

ED conducts raids in multi-crore SRMF land grab case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has conducted extensive searches under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), in connection with an alleged multi-crore land grab and forgery racket involving properties of the Spiritual Regeneration Movement Foundation of India (SRMF).

The probe began after the agency registered an Enforcement Case Information Report (ECIR) on May 7 against a syndicate accused of forging documents, impersonating office bearers of the trust and illegally selling valuable land parcels across several states.

The ED identified G. Ram Chandra Mohan and Akash Malviya as the principal accused and alleged masterminds of the conspiracy. Officials alleged that despite previous arrests in a 2011 land fraud case in Chhattisgarh, the accused continued similar activities through associates and related entities.

Searches were conducted at multiple premises in Delhi and Noida linked to the accused, including locations associated with Singhvahini Infra Projects Pvt. Ltd. and its director Pradeep Singh.

SRMF, registered in 1963 under the Societies Registration Act and associated with the teachings of Maharishi Mahesh Yogi, owns large immovable properties across different states. The ED alleged that forged authority letters, fabricated board resolutions and fake seals were used to falsely portray the accused as authorised office bearers and execute illegal land deals.

One major transaction under scrutiny involves a 3,610-hectare land parcel in Noida's Gejha Tilpatabad village with a reported circle rate of ₹33.61 crore. Investigators alleged the land was fraudulently sold in December 2025 for ₹16 crore through a fictitious entity bearing SRMF's name.

Further investigation into the money trail is underway.

Mann felicitates girls who bagged top 3 ranks in PSEB Class 12 exam

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Thursday felicitated three girl students who bagged the top three positions in the PSEB Class 12 results.

Mann hailed Supneet Kaur from Mansa, and Suhani Chauhan and Divyanshi from Ludhiana, who scored a perfect 500 out of 500. The chief minister presented each student with a cash prize of Rs 50,000 in recognition of their exceptional achievement.

Interacting with the students, Mann said, "It is a matter of immense pride and satisfaction that all three toppers are national and state-level players, which clearly shows that they are excelling in every field."

He added, "All the toppers belong to humble backgrounds and want to excel in life



through hard work and dedication. The Punjab government will extend full support and cooperation to them in achieving their dreams." Highlighting the continued outstanding performance of girls in academics, Mann said: "It is a matter of great pride and satisfaction for all of us that with the spread of education in society, girls have outshone boys not only in academics but in every field. Time

has proved that girls are not inferior to boys in any context and by excelling in academics, they have shown that there is no match for their wisdom, skills and expertise," he added.

Mann said around 2.65 lakh students had appeared in the examinations, of which approximately 2.42 lakh students passed, taking the overall pass percentage to nearly 91.46 per cent.

MPOST

HEALTHCARE DEVELOPMENT PLAN REVIEWED

Haryana to achieve 'Viksit Bharat' goals before 2047: CM Nayab Saini

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday said the state would achieve the targets of 'Viksit Bharat-2047' ahead of schedule and stressed the need for coordinated efforts by all departments to strengthen healthcare delivery and disease prevention systems.

Reviewing the five-year implementation roadmap and action plan prepared by the Health Department, the Chief Minister said departments should seek support from world-class professional teams and adopt modern technologies on the lines of developed nations and states to accelerate implementation of welfare schemes. He said the government's aim was to ensure accessible, affordable and safe healthcare for every citizen.

Saini directed officials to work towards significantly reducing infant and maternal mortality rates in the state. He proposed the establishment



Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini chairs a meeting to review the action plans of the Health department in Chandigarh on Thursday

MPOST

of a round-the-clock centralised control room, functioning like a war room, for daily monitoring of the health of pregnant women and infants to prevent lapses in care. He also asked officials to prepare a detailed action plan for children's health.

The Chief Minister emphasised the need for complete online records of medicines in hospitals so that prescriptions and stock updates are mon-

itored in real time to avoid shortages. He said approval had already been granted for procurement of 70 ambulances to strengthen emergency healthcare services.

Saini further directed that health check-ups should be extended to children studying in private schools in addition to government schools and Anganwadi centres. He also stressed awareness campaigns on healthy living

among children.

Additional Chief Secretary, Health Department, Dr Sumita Misra informed the meeting that free chemotherapy was being provided through Day-Care Cancer Centres for patients referred by medical colleges.

The Chief Minister directed installation of mammography machines in every district for cancer screening.

Saini also called for intensified efforts to make every ward and village TB-free by 2030 through early detection, large-scale screening and proper treatment. He asked departments to focus more on disease prevention, balanced nutrition, mental health support and de-addiction awareness.

He further directed officials to explore PPP models for medical colleges, upgrade trauma centres to Level-1 and Level-2 standards and promote plantation drives under the 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' campaign across hospitals and medical campuses.

At least three workers were killed and 15 persons injured after a fire broke out following an explosion at a firecracker factory in Madhya Pradesh's Dewas district on Thursday, an official said.

Chief Minister Mohan Yadav expressed grief over the incident and ordered an investigation. The state government will provide an assistance of Rs 4 lakh to the kin of each of the deceased, and the injured will receive free treatment, he said in a post on X.

Three persons were killed in the fire at the firecracker unit located in Tonk Kalan area, and around 15 injured persons were sent to hospitals in Indore and Dewas, Collector Rituraj Singh told reporters after inspecting the site.

Videos of the aftermath surfaced on social media, showing



Debris scattered at the site after an explosion at a firecracker factory in Tonk Kalan area of Dewas district, Madhya Pradesh, Thursday

PTI

thick white smoke billowing from the factory along the Agra-Mumbai national highway. The clips also showed people rushing the injured for treatment amid cries for help, with body parts seen scattered at the site.

The collector said the fire has been brought under control. The administration has taken possession of explosives

stored at another location within the unit, he said.

The work to manufacture small firecrackers at the factory of a person named Anil Malviya had begun only 15 days ago, and a licence has been issued for the unit, the collector said.

A detailed investigation is underway into the incident, he added.

GSC seeks amendments to Punjab's anti-sacrilege law

CHANDIGARH: The Global Sikh Council (GSC), an international representative body of overseas Sikh institutions, has urged immediate amendments to Punjab's Jaagat Jot Sri Guru Granth Sahib Satkar (Amendment) Act, 2026, expressing concern that certain provisions of the law could adversely affect Sikh religious practices and institutions.

In a letter to Giani Kuldeep Singh Gargaj, acting Jathedar of Sri Akal Takht Sahib, the GSC sought "sovereign Panthic intervention" to ensure corrective amendments to the legislation. Copies were also sent to Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and Chief Secretary K.A.P. Sinha.

GSC president Kanwaljit Kaur said the community continues to support strict punishment for deliberate sacrilege, but warned that the amended law contains "critical flaws" that could create distress among Sikhs. The council's principal objection is that the Act allegedly allows police authorities to interpret violations of Sikh Rehat Maryada while registering sacrilege-related cases.

Nation Briefs

TDB, HELIX CELL INK PACT FOR NEXT-GEN CANCER THERAPY DEVELOPMENT

NEW DELHI: The Technology Development Board (TDB) has signed an agreement with Hyderabad-based Helix Cell Therapeutics for the development of a next-generation CAR-T cell therapy for Multiple Myeloma, an incurable blood cancer. The project will be implemented under an Indo-Singapore collaboration with Biocell Innovations. The proposed therapy adopts a dual-targeting strategy aimed at both BCMA and CD19 markers found on myeloma cells, unlike existing CAR-T therapies that target only BCMA. CAR-T treatment involves genetically modifying a patient's T lymphocytes to recognise and eliminate cancer cells. Officials said the dual-target approach could improve treatment effectiveness.

RLY BOARD'S ADDL MEMBER VISITS RCF

KAPURTHALA: Sitaram Sinku, Additional Member (Production Units), Railway Board, on Thursday visited Rail Coach Factory, Kapurthala. Sinku inspected the coach manufacturing processes in the workshop and also examined the manufacturing of various types of coaches, besides inspecting the coach shells in the Shell Assembly Shop. He praised RCF infrastructure for speedy manufacturing. Later, he held an elaborate meeting with Ajay Nandan, General Manager and senior officers.





EDITORIAL

REVISING THE
REPUBLIC

The Election Commission's decision to roll out the third phase of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls across 16 states and three Union Territories marks one of the most extensive voter verification exercises undertaken in recent years. Covering nearly 36.73 crore voters through house-to-house verification by more than 3.9 lakh booth-level officers, the exercise is being presented as a necessary democratic cleanup — a way to remove duplicate, deceased, shifted or otherwise ineligible voters from India's electoral rolls. On paper, the logic is difficult to dispute. A credible democracy depends on accurate voter lists. Electoral integrity cannot survive if rolls remain inflated with dead names, duplicate entries, or fictitious voters. Yet the scale, timing, and political sensitivity of the exercise demand a far deeper public conversation than the administrative language currently surrounding it.

The Election Commission argues that the revision is essential to ensure that “only eligible voters are included and no ineligible names remain.” The numbers from earlier phases are indeed striking. In phase two alone, electoral rolls across nine states and three Union Territories reportedly shrank by more than 10 per cent, with over five crore names removed and more than 60 lakh deceased voters identified. Such figures inevitably raise troubling questions about the state of India's electoral databases before the revision began. If the deletions are genuinely accurate, then the exercise has exposed a worrying administrative complacency that allowed deeply outdated rolls to persist for years. At the same time, deletions on such a massive scale also generate anxiety about whether legitimate voters may have been excluded because of bureaucratic error, documentation gaps, migration, or poor verification practices. In democracies, the removal of even a small percentage of genuine voters can have serious political and constitutional consequences.

This concern becomes sharper in India's social context, where mobility, poverty and documentation remain deeply uneven. Millions of Indians migrate seasonally for work. Many live in informal settlements without stable addresses. Elderly citizens, tribal communities, internally displaced persons, and economically vulnerable populations often struggle with documentation requirements. House-to-house verification exercises may appear neutral administratively, but in practice, they depend heavily on local discretion, bureaucratic capacity, and political atmosphere. A voter who missed during verification may not even realise their exclusion until election day arrives. The danger is not merely technical disenfranchisement; it is democratic invisibility. The right to vote is not simply another welfare entitlement. It is the foundational mechanism through which citizens remain politically visible to the state.

The political environment surrounding the SIR exercise further complicates perceptions of neutrality. Several opposition-ruled states, including Karnataka, Telangana, Punjab and Jharkhand, are part of the latest phase. Previous revisions in politically sensitive states such as West Bengal and Uttar Pradesh generated intense political debate after large-scale deletions were reported. In Assam, where citizenship questions remain linked to the unresolved National Register of Citizens (NRC) process, the Election Commission itself avoided a full SIR and instead opted for a “special revision,” recognising the legal and social sensitivity of voter verification in the state. That distinction matters. Electoral roll revision cannot be viewed in isolation from broader anxieties around identity, migration and citizenship. When large-scale verification exercises occur in polarised political climates, even technically legitimate processes risk losing public trust unless accompanied by extraordinary transparency.

The challenge before the Election Commission, therefore, is not merely administrative efficiency but democratic credibility. Public trust in elections depends as much on perceived fairness as on procedural correctness. This requires the Commission to go beyond routine press releases and adopt a far more transparent communication strategy. Political parties must receive full access to revision data. Appeals and objections must be processed quickly and fairly. Enumeration methods should be publicly scrutinised. Citizens whose names are removed must be informed clearly and given accessible mechanisms for restoration. Most importantly, the Commission must ensure that the burden of proving eligibility does not disproportionately fall upon the poor, migrants, minorities, or those living at the margins of state documentation systems. A democracy cannot allow the franchise to become conditional upon bureaucratic sophistication.

India unquestionably needs clean electoral rolls. Electoral fraud, duplication, and outdated databases weaken democracy. But democracies are judged not only by how effectively they remove illegitimate voters, but also by how carefully they protect legitimate ones. The Special Intensive Revision is therefore more than a technical exercise. It is a test of institutional balance. If conducted with transparency, accountability and sensitivity, it can strengthen confidence in India's electoral system. But if pursued with opacity, inconsistency, or excessive zeal, it risks creating precisely the opposite outcome — a democracy where citizens begin to fear exclusion more than they trust participation. In a republic as vast and unequal as India, that would be a dangerous erosion indeed.

CHANGING
TIDE



G PALANITHURAI

THE WRITER IS A FORMER PROFESSOR AND RAJIV GANDHI CHAIR FOR PANCHAYATI RAJ STUDIES, GANDHIGRAM RURAL INSTITUTE

Tamil Nadu's 2026 election may have changed more than just political equations. Is this the beginning of a new political era in the state?

SILENT
KILLER



AMAL CHANDRA

THE WRITER IS A POLICY ANALYST AND A COLUMNIST

Experts increasingly warn that climate change, habitat disruption and expanding human settlements are worsening encounters between humans and snakes across India

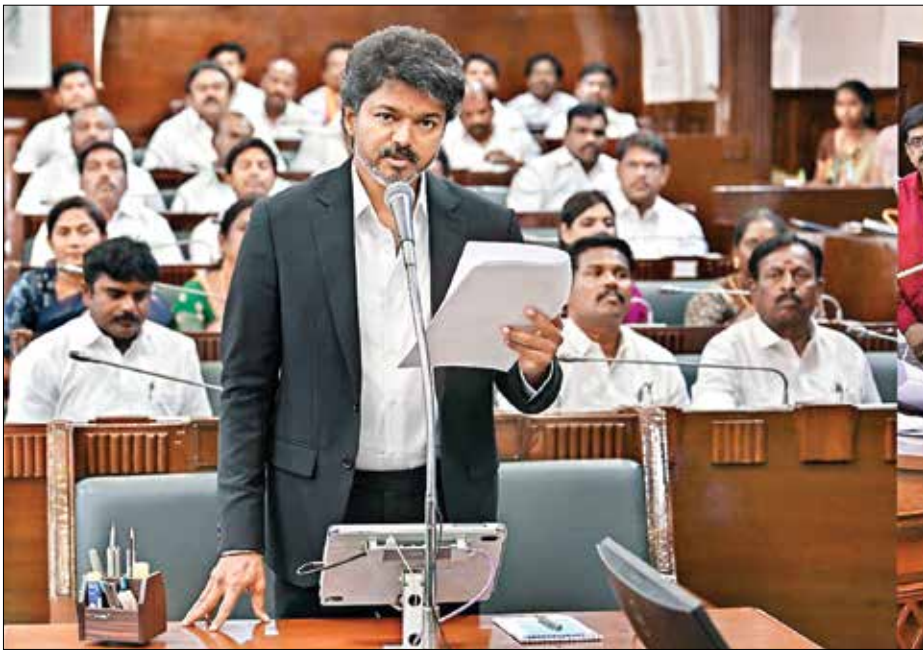
Cracks in Binary Politics

Vijay's emergence disrupted Tamil Nadu's traditional political order, challenging money power, organisational politics and decades of entrenched electoral assumptions

Vox Populi Suprema Lex. In a democracy, the people's voice is the final public will, which is the supreme will. Actor Vijay dismantled several myths that prevailed in Tamil Nadu politics. All political parties strongly believed in money power, through which one can reach power and retain power. This belief strongly percolated into the minds of politicians across all political parties. It is partly true even in this election. But that myth has been broken by Actor Vijay, who secured 35 per cent of the votes polled without bribery.

Secondly, it was believed that without organisational strength, no one could reach power. This was discussed repeatedly in media discourses. Many argued that it was only a crowd and that it would not be converted into votes, as there was no organisational culture. Those who know the theory of organisational behaviour would agree that the above point is valid. But Actor Vijay dismissed this premise and the theory that one cannot reach power through one man's communication without having a strong organisational structure. Actor Vijay drove his fans and followers to the polling booths.

In Tamil Nadu, over the past thirty years, politics has become a lucrative business. Consequently, a large number of people with enormous ill-got wealth have entered politics. They came into politics not out of ideology but with the basic aim of earning money. It is being argued that governments have regularised corruption as an acceptable phenomenon. People have been severely affected because of organised corruption, and they have lost hope that the situation can be redeemed from the



The election suggested voters increasingly seek alternatives to corruption-driven politics

organised loot carried out by the party in power and colluding officials. In order to reduce the fury and wrath of the poor, governments announced and implemented a series of populist schemes, in which party men also received their lion's share. Through ill-got money, political parties firmly believed that votes could be purchased. They had been successful in doing so for the last 30 years. This belief system has been dismantled by Actor Vijay. Without distributing money, he contested the election, and during the campaign, he focused only on the corrupt practices of the ruling establishment and refused to align with the opposition party. It was believed that with money and power, one could do whatever one wanted, but this notion has now been torpedoed.

Being an actor, he correctly

sensed the mood of the people. Every time the Prime Minister came to Tamil Nadu, he lambasted the ruling establishment by citing statistics of corruption in Tamil Nadu's governance. For the past twelve years, the central government has not booked a single individual for corruption. It uses corruption as an issue during elections, but it does not genuinely seek to end corruption. The issue of corruption was initially taken up by Annamalai when he was the president of the Tamil Nadu BJP, and he deepened the discourse. It was then cleverly handled by Actor Vijay, who created a new binary between money, power and personality. Many argued that after the demise of Jayalalithaa and M. Karunanidhi, a leadership crisis loomed large. This gap was identified by Actor Vijay, who emerged as a mass leader and challenged the power of money.

The two alliances were formidable in terms of party strength on both sides.

In the beginning, he too wanted to form an alliance and openly stated that he was ready to form a coalition government. However, parties that had once advocated coalition politics refused to accept his argument that the people of Tamil Nadu had never believed in coalition governments. Hence, they rejected his proposal. As a result, he was forced to face the election single-handedly. Since he was contesting alone, he was pressured to join the NDA in order to defeat the DMK. He refused to budge, as he sensed the mood of his followers. All political parties, whether small or major, failed to understand the ground reality because they had not been with the people over the last thirty years. People had become completely alien-

ated from politics. Vijay identified this gap and established an emotional connection with the people. He was the only leader in Tamil Nadu politics who could attract crowds without offering anything to those attending his meetings. All other parties spent huge amounts of money to bring people to their leaders' meetings. Having sensed Vijay's ability to attract people, many challenges were created to obstruct his roadshows. He faced all these challenges single-handedly during the election. Had he campaigned further across all regions, his vote share would have increased enormously.

Now, binary politics may gradually come to an end, although, for the time being, the DMK and the AIADMK continue to dominate the legislature. In due course, how these three forces play their cards before the people will determine the fate of the parties. The Indian National Congress, once a ruling party, is now insignificant. In the same way, the AIADMK may also be reduced to an insignificant force. The DMK, however, is likely to survive, as it is scientifically organised as a business-model party that can keep its cadre alive even without power, and for a much longer period.

What emerges from the electioneering in Tamil Nadu in 2026 is that voters preferred a new establishment in power by refusing to take money for their votes and instead voting for Vijay. Yet another thesis is that voters accepted money from both parties but ultimately cast their votes according to their own preference between the DMK and the AIADMK. The major victory, however, belongs to democracy and the people.

Views expressed are personal

Snakebite and India's Neglect

Snakebite remains one of India's deadliest yet most neglected public health crises, exposing deep inequalities in healthcare access nationwide

As temperatures rise across India, public attention understandably turns to heatwaves, water scarcity and power demand. Yet another danger often intensifies during hotter months, though it is not confined to any single season: snakebite. It kills quietly, disproportionately and often invisibly, taking thousands of lives each year. While summer conditions can increase encounters in many regions, snakebite remains a year-round public health crisis driven by poverty, weak healthcare access, environmental change and chronic policy neglect.

Recent incidents underline the urgency. For instance, in Kerala, at least six snakebite-related deaths were reported from different parts of the state within a week. In Kuttaiyad in Kozhikode district, five venomous snakes were reportedly found inside a single house, a reminder that human-snake encounters are no longer confined to forests or farmlands. During hotter months, reptiles often seek shade, moisture and cooler shelter, sometimes bringing them closer to homes, storage spaces and water sources. But the wider truth is that snakebite threatens communities across seasons, especially where housing is unsafe, livelihoods depend on outdoor labour, and treatment remains distant.

India bears the world's heaviest snakebite burden, accounting for nearly half of global snakebite deaths according to the World Health Organisation. A study estimated about 1.2 million snakebite deaths in India between 2000 and 2019, averaging around 58,000 deaths annually, well over 150 every day, making it a continuing national tragedy rather than a seasonal anomaly. Globally, snakebite envenoming remains one of the deadliest yet most neglected health crises, with the WHO estimating 4.5 to 5.4 million bites each year, including 1.8 to 2.7 million envenoming cases, causing 81,000 to 138,000 deaths and leaving up to 400,000 survivors with amputations, blindness, severe scarring or other permanent disabilities.

The burden falls overwhelmingly on the poor. Snakebite is a crisis of inequality in which access to treatment is too often a privilege rather than a right. It affects rural labourers, tribal communities, fisherfolk, plantation workers, women gathering firewood and children walking barefoot. A bite that might be survivable in a well-connected urban setting can become fatal in a remote vil-



India records the world's highest number of snakebite deaths, largely affecting poor rural communities

lage simply because help arrives too late.

India's rural economy helps explain the scale of the problem. Farmers working in paddy fields, plantations, irrigation channels and crop storage zones are especially vulnerable. Many bites occur at night when people walk outdoors without lighting or sleep on floors. Poor sanitation and unmanaged waste can attract prey species, increasing snake presence.

Summer intensifies these risks in many areas. High temperatures may drive snakes toward cooler indoor corners, wells or water tanks. People often sleep outdoors or keep doors open for ventilation. Agricultural workers shift schedules to dawn or dusk to avoid peak heat, increasing movement when some snakes are active. Children also spend more time outdoors during school breaks. But monsoon, harvest activity and year-round habitat disruption create danger too.

Climate change is likely to worsen the challenge. Rising temperatures, erratic rainfall, droughts and floods can alter snake habitats and movement patterns. Floodwaters may displace snakes into homes and shelters, while drought can push both people and wildlife toward shrinking water sources. Expanding settlements into ecological edges creates new zones of contact. Snakebite policy can no longer be separated from climate resilience and land-use planning.

Despite the scale of the crisis, India's response remains too narrow. Public discussion often treats anti-snake venom as the singular answer, and antivenom is indeed indispensable when given correctly and in time. But antivenom alone cannot solve the emergency. Many victims never receive treatment

quickly enough. Families may first turn to traditional remedies, lose crucial time arranging transport, or travel long distances to facilities that are inadequately staffed. In neurotoxic bites from cobras or kraits, respiratory paralysis can develop rapidly. Viper bites may trigger bleeding disorders, shock or kidney injury. Delay is deadly.

Even where antivenom is available, many facilities are not equipped to use it effectively. Stocks may be inconsistent, cold-chain storage unreliable, staff inadequately trained, and critical support such as ventilators or dialysis unavailable; a vial on a shelf is not the same as a functioning treatment system.

There is also a scientific gap: India's polyvalent antivenoms have historically focused on the “big four” snakes — Indian cobra, common krait, Russell's viper and saw-scaled viper — despite the country's far wider snake diversity and regional variations in venom, underscoring the need for stronger research, region-specific formulations and continuous quality review.

Survival is not the only measure of harm. Thousands who live through snakebite are left with amputations, chronic pain, kidney damage, disability, trauma and debt. For poor households, one bite can become a multi-year economic catastrophe.

What India needs is a comprehensive public health strategy. Prevention must come first. Safer rural housing with sealed entry points, rodent control, raised sleeping arrangements and proper storage can reduce indoor bites. Reliable electricity and street lighting are important preventive tools. So are footwear campaigns, torch use at night and school-based awareness on avoiding risky contact with debris, vegetation and

dark corners.

Rapid access to care is equally essential. High-incidence districts need mapped referral systems, ambulance networks, 24-hour stabilisation centres and trained frontline staff, with resources directed to known hotspots. India also needs far better data, as many deaths occur outside hospitals or are misclassified. Real-time district surveillance linking hospitals, primary health centres and community reporting would enable smarter planning and faster intervention. Antivenom policy must be modernised through research investment, predictable manufacturing, strict quality assurance and regionally effective products. Rehabilitation should be recognised as part of treatment through prosthetics, physiotherapy, renal monitoring, mental health care and livelihood support.

Even states with stronger health indicators are not immune. Snakebite is no longer confined to poorer regions or remote forests. Rapid urbanisation near green belts, waste accumulation that attracts rodents, fragmented habitats and expanding settlements are bringing snakes into closer contact with people. Public attitudes, therefore, need to be balanced: snakes should neither be demonised nor romanticised. Most species are non-venomous and play important ecological roles, especially in rodent control, so indiscriminate killing is harmful. But reverence without safety awareness can also cost lives. Coexistence must be guided by science through rescue networks, habitat management, public education and emergency preparedness.

India has addressed other neglected health burdens when political will aligned with strong public systems, and snakebite deserves the same seriousness. The country should launch a national mission combining awareness campaigns, clinical training, emergency transport, hotspot mapping, research funding and survivor rehabilitation. Every season brings different risks, but snakebite remains a year-round crisis until policy changes. It may be one of humanity's oldest threats, but in modern India, many deaths still reflect contemporary failures: delayed care, unequal access and official neglect. Antivenom can save lives, but only a stronger public health system can prevent India from losing tens of thousands more.

Views expressed are personal

MI(ghty) Tilak

Batter stars after Shardul's 4-for as MI crush PBKS' playoff hopes

DHARAMSHALA: Punjab Kings slumped to their fifth straight defeat, seriously hurting their playoff hopes, as Mumbai Indians cruised to a six-wicket win in a crucial IPL clash on Thursday riding on Shardul Thakur's four-wicket haul and a clinical batting effort from Tilak Varma, who smashed 75.

Asked to bat first, Prabhsimran Singh (57) added a 33-ball 50-run opening stand with Priyansh Arya (27) to take PBKS to 55 for 1 in the power-play and then added 57 runs with Cooper Connolly to go past the 100-run mark in the 12th over.

Shardul (4/39) brought MI back into the game with a four-wicket burst but PBKS managed to pile up 53 runs in the last three overs to post a competitive 200 for 8.

Chasing the target, Ryan Rickelton came out blazing as he single-handedly propelled Mumbai Indians to 59 for no loss despite Rohit Sharma's scratchy 25 at the other end.

PBKS fought back with three wickets for 57 runs between the seventh and 13th overs, but Tilak Varma anchored the chase superbly with an unbeaten 33-ball 75. He first stitched a 61-run stand off 42 balls with Sherfane Ruth-



Tilak Varma remained not out on 75 off 33 balls

PTI

erford (20) and then combined with Will Jacks to steer MI home in 19.5 overs. The defeat severely dented Punjab playoff hopes as they now need to win both their remaining matches to stay in contention for a top-four finish.

Defending 200, Arshdeep Singh delivered two outstanding overs with the new ball,

conceding just eight runs, but lacked support from the other end as Rickelton tore into the attack with four boundaries and four sixes during his explosive 23-ball 48.

Skipper Shreyas Iyer rotated his seamers in the powerplay, but Rickelton launched the assault with a six off Azmatullah Omarzai before hammer-

ing Marco Jansen and Xavier Bartlett. Azmatullah eventually provided the breakthrough by dismissing Rickelton, while Jansen removed Naman Dhir (9). Yuzvendra Chahal then pulled things back briefly with a superb spell, first strangling Rohit for runs and later casting him as MI slipped to 89 for 3.

Tilak and Rutherford rebuilt the innings calmly before shifting gears, targeting Azmatullah for a 13-run over to ease the pressure. Arshdeep nearly provided another breakthrough when Tilak miscued a skier, but Jansen failed to hold on to a difficult chance.

With 72 needed off the last five overs, PBKS turned to Chahal again, but Tilak and Rutherford counterattacked brilliantly, taking 20 runs off the leg-spinner's over. Although Azmatullah dismissed Rutherford in the 17th over, Tilak remained unfazed, smashing Jansen for two sixes and a four in a 22-run 18th over to decisively swing the chase in MI's favour.

Needing 15 from six balls, Tilak smashed two sixes to knock off the winning runs. Earlier, Deepak Chahar (2/36) struck first for MI, cleaning up Arya in the fifth over but stand-in skipper Jasprit Bumrah was unlucky not to get Prabhsimran before.

AGENCIES

'Kohli has silenced doubters'

RAIPUR: Batting maestro Virat Kohli proved that the "old generation is still the best" with his unbeaten century against Kolkata Knight Riders, former India captain Sunil Gavaskar said while lavishing praise on the Royal Challengers Bengaluru star for silencing doubters in the ongoing IPL.

Coming off two successive ducks, the 37-year-old Kohli smashed an unbeaten hundred to guide Royal Challengers Bengaluru to a six-wicket win over KKR and move to the top of the points table here on Wednesday.

"Virat Kohli was absolutely outstanding against KKR. He knows how to construct a chase better than most," he said. "While everyone was talking about this being the season of 'Gen Next', Kohli showed he is still around. He silenced the doubters with a ton."

AGENCIES

Murmurs, misfires and a sudden exit: Why Sreejesh's tenure ended

NEW DELHI: A fairly successful stint has ended on a rather bitter note and despite the talk of an expired contract, PR Sreejesh' exit as India's junior men's hockey coach does not seem to be a straightforward call.

The two-time Olympics bronze medallist's tenure ended just 17 months into the job following the end of his contract after guiding India to a bronze medal finish at the Junior World Cup in Chennai and Madurai last year.

Sreejesh re-applied for the job but the goalkeeping stalwart was ignored. On Thursday, the Hockey India officially appointed decorated Frenchman Frederic Soyeza as the junior men's team coach.

The national body maintains that there was nothing sinister to be read in its decision to not renew Sreejesh's contract. But the celebrated former goalkeeper did not hold back when he took to the social media to say that the national body had ignored him to accommodate a foreign coach being demanded by senior men's coach Craig Fulton.

Caught in the arguments and counter-arguments are the players and when PTI reached out to a few of them, it was learnt that there was a level of dissatisfaction as well.

"Some players of the junior team were not happy



Frenchman Frederic Soyeza has replaced PR Sreejesh as junior men's coach

HI

with Sreejesh's working style, they couldn't reach him when needed over phone when camps were not in progress," a well-placed source said.

However, another source said Sreejesh was available whenever needed and his record as a coach was proof enough. During his tenure India won five medals in as many tournaments.

But Hockey India argued that the decision to let him go was taken considering long-term vision of building a sustainable high-performance ecosystem aligned with India's ambitions of hosting the 2036 Olympic Games.

"We have not fired Sreejesh. His contract expired in December 2025 and we followed the due process of and advertised for the position. He also applied and applicants were short-listed and finalised as per a proper selection process basis merit," said HI President

The national body maintains that there was nothing sinister to be read in its decision to not renew Sreejesh's contract

Dilip Tirkey.

"We never wanted him to come out of the coaching programme, we offered him to lead the developmental programme, India A and beyond that. Besides that we offered him to guide our goalkeepers at the national level with his vast experience, but he refused," he asserted. "But the doors are always open for him and other Indian coaches."

Sreejesh's transition from an Olympic medal-winning goalkeeper to junior India coach was a rare privilege, an appointment made straight from the field with zero formal coaching experience. Having mostly played under foreign coaches -- Roelant Oltmans, Terry Walsh, Graham Reid, and Craig Fulton -- it was also puzzling to witness the India vs foreign coach narrative from Sreejesh in his social media outburst, where he stated that the decision to appoint a foreign coach for junior side was taken at the behest of Fulton.

AGENCIES

Sindhu, Sen enter Thailand Open last-8

BANGKOK: Indian shuttlers PV Sindhu and Lakshya Sen advanced to the quarterfinals of the USD 500,000 Thailand Open Super 500 with straight-game wins in their respective matches here on Thursday.

Sixth seed Sindhu needed just 28 minutes to outclass Denmark's Amalie Schulz 21-13, 21-15 in the women's singles second round.

Seventh seed Lakshya defeated China's Zhu Xuan Chen 21-12, 21-13 in a men's singles clash that lasted 39 minutes. Sindhu will next face top

seed and world No. 3 Akane Yamaguchi of Japan, while Lakshya will take on Thailand's second seed Kunlavut Vitidsarn.

India's top-seeded men's doubles pair of Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty also marched into the last-eight stage with a 21-12, 21-19 win over Malaysia's Bryan Jeremy Goonting and Muham Haikal. However, former world No. 1 Kidambi Srikanth crashed out after going down 16-21, 21-11, 18-21 to Chinese Taipei's world No. 47 Su Li Yang.

AGENCIES

— BREAKS DJOKOVIC'S RECORD EN ROUTE ITALIAN OPEN SEMIS RUN — Rome sweet Rome for rampaging Sinner

ROME: Jannik Sinner is two victories away from becoming the first home man to win the Italian Open in half a century. And it doesn't seem like anybody can stop him — either in Rome or at the French Open that starts in 10 days.

The top-ranked Sinner landed shots on the lines repeatedly in a 6-2, 6-4 triumph over No. 14 Andrey Rublev to reach the semifinals Thursday and move past Novak Djokovic with a record 32nd consecutive victory in Masters 1000 events — the biggest tournaments outside the Grand Slams.



"I don't play for records. I play just for my own story. And obviously at the same time it means a lot to me," Sinner said.



The last Italian man to raise the singles trophy on the red clay of the Foro Italico was Adriano Panatta in 1976. Pan-

atta will present the title to this year's champion on Sunday, with Italy President Sergio Mattarella also slated to attend the final. "It's a special tournament for me," Sinner said.

With nearly everyone inside the 10,500-seat Campo Centrale cheering for Sinner, many supporters wore hats and T-shirts in orange — his theme color. One group of fans held up a sign that said, "Sinner, Faccè Sogna" — "Sinner, Make us dream." He lost last year's final in Rome to Carlos Alcaraz, who is now sidelined due to a wrist injury.

AGENCIES

Nikhat out of CWG, Asian Games reckoning

PATIALA: Two-time world champion Nikhat Zareen suffered a shock exit from the Commonwealth Games and Asian Games trials here on Thursday even as a majority of the boxers welcomed the return of the trial-based selection system.

Nikhat, the 2022 Birmingham Commonwealth Games champion and 2023 Hangzhou Asian Games bronze medalist, went down 1-4 via split decision to Sakshi Chaudhary in the 51kg semifinals in the opening bout of the day.

The Boxing Federation of India was forced to revert to the trial-based selection process after the Sports Authority of India (SAI) suspended its earlier assessment-based evaluation system on Sunday, calling it "opaque". "The trial system is much better. We don't have to keep stressing about whether we are selected or not as we would keep waiting for the list a week after the assessment," a boxer with multiple international said.

"Trials are fair and square," said another boxer.

AGENCIES

World

— XI URGES US TO EXERCISE EXTRA CAUTION IN HANDLING TAIWAN ISSUE —

Rubio says US policy toward Taiwan 'unchanged' after Trump-Xi meeting

BEIJING: Secretary of State Marco Rubio said US policy toward Taiwan is "unchanged" after President Donald Trump's meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping but warned it would be "a terrible mistake" for China to take Taiwan by force.

Rubio made the remarks in an interview with NBC News while travelling with the president on his trip to China.

He sidestepped Xi's warning that differences over the self-governing island could lead to a clash, and said that China always raises the issue of Taiwan in talks.

"US policy on the issue of Taiwan is unchanged as of today and as of the meeting that we had here today. It was raised. They always raise it on their side. We always make clear our position, and we move on to the other topics," Rubio said.



Secretary of State Marco Rubio

Chinese President Xi Jinping told his US counterpart Donald Trump that not handling the Taiwan issue properly could trigger "clashes and even conflicts" between the two countries, as the leaders held wide-ranging talks on the Iran war, energy security and trade on Thursday.

After concluding the first round of talks in Beijing, which lasted for around two hours, Trump invited Xi and his wife to the White House on September 24, even as both leaders were in agreement that the Strait of Hormuz needs to be opened to support global energy needs, the White House said in a statement.

Highlights

» Rubio made the remarks in an interview with NBC News

» The Secretary of State has sidestepped Xi's warning over Taiwan

» 'China and the US have agreed on a new vision for building constructive bilateral ties'

China and the US have agreed on a "new vision" for building constructive bilateral ties, Xi said.

"I have agreed with President Trump on a new vision of building a constructive China-US relationship of strategic stability."

Xi said the "new vision" would provide strategic guidance for bilateral relations over the next three years and

beyond, and should be welcomed by the people of both countries as well as the international community, official media reported.

He, however, stressed that the Taiwan question remained the most important issue in China-US relations.

If it is handled properly, the bilateral relationship "will enjoy overall stability", Xi said. Otherwise, the two countries could face "clashes and even conflicts", putting bilateral ties in great jeopardy, the leader was quoted as saying by the state-run Xinhua news agency.

The Chinese president urged the US to exercise extra caution in handling the Taiwan issue.

In response to Xi's comments, Taiwan was quoted by the AP news agency saying: "China is currently the only risk to regional peace and stability."

AGENCIES

Political crisis deepens in UK as health secretary resigns

LONDON: Efforts to unseat British Prime Minister Keir Starmer from inside his own government broke out into open rebellion Thursday, with one potential rival resigning from the Cabinet and another clearing the way to enter any future leadership contest.

Health Secretary Wes Streeting became the first senior minister to quit Starmer's Cabinet on Thursday in what is expected to be a precursor to challenging his leadership.

Starmer is facing growing pressure from his own Labour



UK Health Secretary Wes Streeting

Party to step down after disastrous results for Labour last week in local and regional elections.

The election drubbing cemented doubts among many Labour lawmakers about Starmer's judgment, vision and leadership ability -- a brutal indictment on a leader who returned the party to power in July 2024 after 14 years in opposition.

"You have shown courage and statesmanship on the world stage -- not least in keeping Britain out of the war in Iran," Streeting wrote in an exhorting resignation letter.

"But where we need vision, we have a vacuum. Where we need direction, we have drift."

AGENCIES

— SNAPS THOUSANDS OF PICTURES — NASA's Psyche spacecraft buzzes Mars on its way to rare metal asteroid

CAPE CANAVERAL: A NASA spacecraft chasing a rare metal asteroid swings past Mars this week for a gravity boost, snapping thousands of pictures as practice for the main encounter in 2029.

Named Psyche like the asteroid it's after, the robotic explorer will slingshot past the red planet at 12,333 mph (19,848 kph) on Friday.

It will be an especially close flyby, with Psyche passing within 2,800 miles (4,500 kilometres) of Mars, equivalent to the distance between

the US east and west coasts. Then it will barrel toward the asteroid belt between Mars and Jupiter that is home to its enticing target. All of the spacecraft's science instruments will be on for the Mars pass. NASA's two Mars rovers along with a small fleet of US and European orbiters will make surface and atmospheric observations at the same time for comparison.

Psyche's cameras already are photographing Mars, appearing as a crescent on approach and a nearly full sphere once it's

in the rearview mirror.

The different views will serve double duty, allowing operators to fine-tune their instruments while providing "just plain beautiful photos," Arizona State University's Jim Bell, the imaging team leader, said in a statement.

While the asteroid belt is swarming with millions of objects, most are made of rock or ice. Only a small percentage are thought to be metal-rich like Psyche, a potato-shaped asteroid roughly 278 kilometres by 232 kilometres.

Scientists suspect the asteroid may be the exposed nickel and iron core of a fledgling planet that was stripped down by cosmic collisions.

Studying such an object up close can yield information about the dawn of our solar system 4.6 billion years ago, and why and how Earth spawned life. Launched in 2023, the spacecraft is midway through its six-year roundabout journey to Psyche in the outer fringes of the asteroid belt, three times farther from the sun than Earth.

AGENCIES

Israeli officials say Hezbollah drone wounds 3 civilians

JERUSALEM: A Hezbollah drone exploded inside Israel on Thursday, injuring three civilians, two of them severely, according to the Israeli military and hospitals.

The incident occurred ahead of a third round of direct talks between Israel and Lebanon in Washington, as the Trump administration pushes for a breakthrough between the two neighbours.

AGENCIES

India caps gold imports under Advance Authorisation at 100 kg

Earlier, there was no limit on gold imports under the scheme

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A day after significantly increasing the import duty on precious metals, the government on Thursday imposed a limit of 100 kg on gold imports under the Advance Authorisation scheme, which allows jewellery exporters to import raw or input materials at zero duty.

The government has tightened conditions for the issuance and monitoring of advance authorisation for import of gold. Earlier, there was no limit on gold imports under the scheme.

The Advance Authorisation scheme allows the duty-free import of inputs that are incorporated into an export product. In addition to any inputs, packaging material, fuel, oil, and catalyst that are consumed or utilised in the process of production of export product, are also allowed.

“AA for import of gold shall be issued, subject to a maximum remissible quantity of 100 kilograms,” the DGFT said in a public notice.

It added that in case of application for Advance Authorisation by a first-time applicant, a mandatory physical inspection of the applicant’s manufacturing facility will be undertaken to verify the existence, capacity and operational status of



It added that in case of application for Advance Authorisation by a first-time applicant, a mandatory physical inspection of the applicant’s manufacturing facility will be undertaken

the unit.

“Any subsequent AA for the import of gold, shall be considered for issuance only upon fulfilment of at least 50 per cent of the export obligation...,” it said, adding that the AA holder will have to submit a fortnightly performance report, which should be duly certified by an independent chartered accountant certifying gold imports and exports undertaken.

Further, the concerned regional authority of the direc-

torate will submit a monthly report to the DGFT containing details regarding the issuance of AA.

The government on Wednesday sharply hiked the import duty on gold and silver to 15 per cent to discourage purchase and trim non-essential imports in the backdrop of a ballooning import bill amid the West Asia crisis.

Effective May 13, import duty on gold and silver has been increased to 15 per cent from

Highlights

» The Advance Authorisation scheme allows the duty-free import of inputs that are incorporated into an export product

» The government on Wednesday sharply hiked the import duty on gold and silver to 15 per cent to discourage purchase and trim non-essential imports

» Gold, silver imports jumped 26.7% y-o-y to \$102.5 billion in FY26, with their share in total imports rising to 14% from 11.8% in FY25

6 per cent, and that on platinum has been raised to 15.4 per cent from 6.4 per cent. Consequential changes have also been made to other items such as gold/silver dore, coins, findings, etc.

Gold and silver imports jumped 26.7 per cent year-on-year to \$102.5 billion in FY2025-26, with their share in total imports rising to 14 per cent from 11.8 per cent in 2024-25.

The duty hike came within

days of Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s clarion call for curbs on gold purchases, along with other austerity measures to reduce avoidable foreign exchange expenditure.

Gold imports in India, the world’s second-biggest gold consumer after China, are driven by the jewellery industry demand. Such imports involve a substantial outflow of foreign exchange.

The rupee hit a record low of 95.75 against the US dollar on Tuesday, but recovered some lost ground on Wednesday after the gold import duty was announced.

Through the duty hikes carried out on Wednesday, basic customs duty on gold has been doubled to 10 per cent, while agriculture infrastructure and development cess (AIDC) has been hiked fivefold from 1 per cent to 5 per cent. This brings the effective import duty on gold and silver to 15 per cent.

Besides, importers have to pay a 3 per cent Integrated GST (IGST), which takes the total duty to 18.45 per cent from 9.18 per cent earlier.

India’s gold imports surged more than 24 per cent to an all-time high of \$71.98 billion in 2025-26. In volume terms, however, shipments dipped 4.76 per cent to 721.03 tonnes in 2025-26.

Adani Airport Holdings inks deal with IHG Hotels & Resorts for developing 5 properties



the rapid expansion of India’s aviation, tourism and airport-led urban infrastructure sectors, AAHL said.

These five hotels will be developed across Jaipur, Mangaluru, Thiruvananthapuram and the Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR), strengthening hospitality infrastructure around major aviation and urban growth corridors, the company said.

AAHL currently operates Mumbai, Navi Mumbai, Ahmedabad, Jaipur, Lucknow, Guwahati, Mangalore and

PV dispatches rise 25.4% YoY to 4,37,312 units in April: SIAM

Passenger vehicle dispatches stood at 3,48,847 units in April 2025, SIAM said in a statement

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Domestic passenger vehicle dispatches from companies to dealers rose 25.4 per cent year-on-year to 4,37,312 units in April this year, kicking off the new fiscal on a strong note by carrying forward the demand momentum after GST rate cut last year, industry body SIAM said on Thursday.

Passenger vehicle dispatches stood at 3,48,847 units in April 2025, SIAM said in a statement, adding that despite concerns of high commodity prices emanating from the West Asia war, the auto industry has been witnessing good demand.

Utility vehicles continued to be the volume driver in the PV segment clocking a growth of 21.5% at 2,44,280 units as compared to 2,01,062 units in April last year.

Passenger car dispatches also rose by 32.7 per cent at 1,20,945 units last month as compared to 91,148 units in the year-ago period, SIAM said.

Sales of vans in the domestic market were at 13,087 units last month as compared to 11,438 units in April 2025, up 14.4 per cent, it added.

Total two-wheeler sales rose 28.4 per cent to 18,72,691 units last month as against 14,58,784 units in April last year, it added.



Utility vehicles continued to be the volume driver in the PV segment clocking a growth of 21.5% at 2,44,280 units as compared to 2,01,062 units in April last year

Motorcycle sales in April 2026 were up 30.6 per cent at 11,38,452 units as against 8,71,666 units in the year-ago month.

Similarly, scooter sales grew by 26.2 per cent at 6,91,993 units last month as compared to 5,48,370 units in the same period last year, SIAM said.

Three-wheeler dispatches

to dealers were up 32.8 per cent last month at 65,668 units as against 49,441 units in the year-ago period, it added.

Overall vehicle wholesales across categories in April grew by 27.9 per cent at 23,16,671 units as compared to 18,11,876 units in the same month last year, SIAM said.

Commenting on the performance, SIAM Director General Rajesh Menon said, “Continuing with the momentum of the second half of FY 2025-26, the first month of FY 2026-27, posted high double-digit growth in passenger vehicles, three-wheelers and two-wheelers.”

Though there are concerns of high commodity prices emanating from the disruptions in West Asia, industry has been witnessing good demand, he added.

GQG sells 58.92L shares of Adani Enterprises for ₹1,435 cr

NEW DELHI: US-based investment firm GQG Partners on Thursday sold 58.92 lakh shares of billionaire Gautam Adani-led Adani Enterprises Ltd for Rs 1,435 crore through an open market transaction.

Rajiv Jain-backed GQG Partners, through its affiliate GQG Partners Emerging Markets Equity Fund, offloaded a total of 58,92,423 shares, representing a 0.45 per cent stake in Adani’s flagship firm Adani Enterprises, as per the block data available on the NSE.

Shares were disposed of at an average price of Rs 2,435.60 apiece, taking the transaction value to Rs 1,435.16 crore.

Following the latest transaction, GQG Partners’ affiliate’s holding in Adani Enterprises declined to 1.14 per cent from 1.59 per cent.

Meanwhile, SBI Mutual Fund purchased an equal number of shares at the same price, as per the data on the NSE.

HUDCO posts ₹4,034 cr profit in FY26

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: Housing and Urban Development Corporation Ltd (HUDCO) reported its highest-ever financial performance for FY26, posting a record net profit of Rs 4,034.37 crore along with all-time high loan sanctions, disbursements and loan book growth.

According to the company, loan sanctions during FY26 rose 29 per cent year-on-year to Rs 1,64,757.79 crore, while loan disbursements jumped 28 per cent to a record Rs 51,194.21 crore. Total loan book also expanded by 29 per cent to Rs 160,724.30 crore, reflecting strong growth momentum while maintaining asset quality.

Revenue from operations in FY26 stood at Rs 13,150.40 crore. The company also reported a reduction of 27 basis point in its overall cost of borrowings & approved an annual borrowing plan of Rs 70,000

Loan sanctions during FY26 rose 29 per cent year-on-year to Rs 1,64,757.79 crore

crore. HUDCO announced its highest-ever total dividend payout of 60.50 per cent, amounting to Rs 6.05 per share, including a final dividend of Rs 1.50 per share, subject to shareholders’ approval.

The company further said its net non-performing assets (NPAs) declined significantly to 0.05 per cent in FY26 from 0.25 per cent in FY25, moving closer towards its goal of becoming a zero net NPA company.

Sanjay Kulshrestha said HUDCO had already achieved its FY26 market guidance of a Rs 1.50 lakh crore loan book by the third quarter of the financial year. He said the company’s

performance was supported by policy reforms, diversification of funding sources, issuance of its first perpetual bonds, stressed asset resolution measures, ESG initiatives, succession planning, digital transformation, and improved governance mechanisms.

Highlighting HUDCO’s developmental initiatives, Kulshrestha said the company has launched the Urban Invest Window (UiWIN) in line with the Government’s Urban Challenge Fund and the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047. The initiative aims to support Urban Local Bodies in developing sustainable and bankable urban infrastructure projects, especially in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities.

He also said HUDCO has expanded its public-private partnership financing portfolio across roads, real estate, energy, airports and seaports to support India’s growing infrastructure needs.

Hindustan Zinc, V-Spark DeepTech host AI showcase, target ₹2K cr value

UDAIPUR: Hindustan Zinc Ltd on Thursday said it is targeting Rs 2,000 crore in value creation through AI-led industrial transformation in partnership with V-Spark DeepTech Ventures. The announcement was made at “Zinnovation 2026”, an AI showcase focused on accel-

erating digital transformation across mining, smelting and manufacturing operations.

The identified value pool is expected to come from productivity gains, cost optimisation, improved asset reliability, energy efficiency, safety enhancement, better recoveries

& faster decision-making across HZL’s operations. V-Spark plans to extend these AI-driven industrial solutions to the wider manufacturing sector. During the event, HZL inked an MoU with XCMG, Sandvik, STL Digital and AVEVA. V-Spark also entered into agreements



with startups, including Infinite Uptime, Symbioticware AI,

Kernely & Flutura, to evaluate and pilot industrial AI solutions for manufacturing applications.

Priya Agarwal Hebbbar, Chairperson, Hindustan Zinc said the company is embedding technology at the core of its operations to create a globally benchmarked metals enterprise

under its HZL 2.0 vision.

Akarsh Hebbbar, Chairman, V-Spark DeepTech Ventures & President, Vedanta Group said AI and collaborative innovation ecosystems would define the next phase of industrial leadership, adding that the platform aims to connect startups, tech-

nology providers and operating businesses to solve industrial challenges at scale.

HZL also showcased its digital mining and smelting capabilities, including tele-remote operations, a wind simulator and virtual demonstrations of its operations.

Mittal plans Airtel succession in 10 years

He desires that promoter Bharti Telecom regains over 50% stake in the firm

NEW DELHI: Telecom czar Sunil Bharti Mittal plans to hand over the reins of Bharti Airtel to his children in the next decade and desires that promoter firm Bharti Telecom regains over 50 per cent stake in the company.

Owned by the Mittal family and Singtel Group, Bharti Telecom holds 40.47 per cent stake in Airtel. The promoter firms, including Bharti Telecom, the Mittal family holding firm Indian Continent Investment, the Singtel Group firm Pastel, and others jointly hold a 48.87 per cent stake in Airtel.

Mittal - whose current term as the company Chairman was due to expire on September 30 - has been reappointed for five years till September 30, 2031.

“My own wish is that in the next - I know it’s hard to put in years on it - decade as I kind of come to a point where I hand over the reins to the next generation as shareholders, Bharti Telecom should get back to controlling shareholding of 51 per cent or just over 50 per cent,” Mittal said.

Mittal, during Bharti Air-

CLOSER LOOK

» Owned by the Mittal family and Singtel Group, Bharti Telecom holds 40.47 per cent stake in Airtel

» The promoter firms, including Bharti Telecom, the Mittal family holding firm Indian Continent Investment, the Singtel Group firm Pastel, and others jointly hold a 48.87 per cent stake in Airtel

tel’s Q4 earnings call on Thursday, said in order to raise Bharti Telecom’s stake by 10 per cent in Airtel, a good amount of cash in hand is needed. It would require an investment of Rs 1 lakh crore based on present share price and market capitalisation of the company.

Bharti Enterprises Holding has a 50.56 per cent stake and Singtel a 49.44 per cent stake in Bharti Telecom.

“You know, basically the belief remains that you must have everything through one company that should be the controlling, promoting shareholder. Bharti Telecom, as you know, historically has not only been the founding promoter of this company (but has also) had almost always for a long period

of time, a controlling shareholding of 51 per cent,” Mittal said.

Mittal said that the shareholding in Airtel can be raised in next 3-4 years, depending on the performance of the company driven by top executives handling day-to-day operations.

Singtel has around a 7 per cent direct stake in Bharti Airtel. “To put a bit more granular sort of angle, Singtel has a 7 per cent direct stake in Airtel and it had about 6 per cent to equalise. Now with this transaction, once this is done and shares are issued, the gap will come down to 3.6 per cent (for a target of 51 per cent). We should see an overall gap dramatically reducing, and Singtel, which has been on the path of selling down its direct stake, has to sell now

much less than earlier,” he said.

Assuming a next 3-4 year timeframe for acquiring a 3.6 per cent balance stake in Airtel, Mittal said that it will depend on the performance of Airtel executive leadership on executing share buybacks, giving out more dividends and generating cash flow to put more cash in hand for Bharti Telecom to achieve the target.

Mittal also said even Airtel should make an attempt to have a higher share in Airtel Africa, around 90 per cent.

The Airtel board on Wednesday approved raising the company’s stake in Airtel Africa by 16.31 per cent to around 79 per cent through a share swap agreement worth Rs 28,220 crore from the 62.73 per cent stake at present.

“The UK regulations allow you to go up to 90 per cent. With this move, we have gone up to 78 per cent. Ambition for Airtel should be whatever is allowed to go up to 90 per cent, they should get there,” Mittal said.

He said Airtel Africa has been doing buybacks from time to time.

BHARTI AIRTEL EMERGED AS BIGGEST GAINER, RALLYING OVER 5%

Sensex soars 790 points driven by buying in telecom, banking stocks

OUR CORRESPONDENT

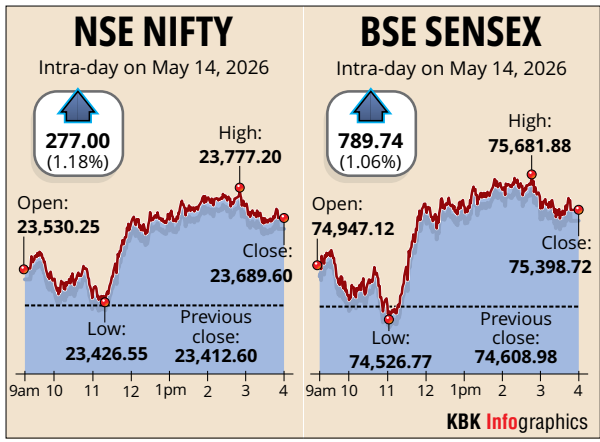
MUMBAI: Stock markets rose for the second consecutive day on Thursday with the benchmark Sensex jumping by nearly 790 points in a volatile session, driven by value buying in telecom, pharma and private banking shares.

The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 789.74 points, or 1.06 per cent, to close at 75,398.72. The index opened higher but slipped into negative territory in late morning deals. However, value buying in telecom and banking shares helped the barometer pare losses and later jump more than 1,000 points to a high of 75,681.88.

Extending gains to the second day, the 50-share NSE Nifty climbed 277 points, or 1.18 per cent, to finish at 23,689.60.

Among Sensex firms, Bharti Airtel emerged as the biggest gainer, rallying over 5 per cent after the telecom carrier's annual revenue crossed the Rs 2 lakh crore mark for the first time.

Eternal rose by 3.32 per cent while HDFC Bank advanced 2.67 per cent, emerging as the major contributor to the Sensex gains. Adani Ports, Sun Pharmaceuticals, Bajaj Finance, Mahindra & Mahindra, NTPC, Kotak Mahindra Bank, Titan, Trent, UltraTech Cement, ITC and State Bank of India were



Among sectoral indices, Telecom rose the most by 2.87%, Healthcare (2.08%), Metal by 2.03%, Utilities (1.59%), Power (1.44%), Top 10 Banks (1.40%), PSU Bank & Pvt Banks Index by 1.38% each

among the other gainers.

On the other hand, Infosys, Tech Mahindra, HCL Technologies, Tata Consultancy Services, Hindustan Unilever, Axis Bank and Maruti Suzuki India ended lower.

“Indian equities staged a counterintuitive recovery from intraday lows and ended higher despite the rupee hitting a record low and crude remaining elevated,” Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Ltd, said.

Investor confidence was bolstered in anticipation of potential government measures to mitigate INR weakness, including consideration of bond tax relief for foreign investors and potential tightening of the Liberalized Remittance Scheme to stem capital outflows, he added.

“Sentiment was further anchored by positive cues from the Trump-Xi summit, which raised hopes of expanding economic cooperation.

“Sectorally, while pharma

Highlights

» Eternal rose by 3.32% & HDFC Bank advanced 2.67%, emerging as major contributor to Sensex gains

» The BSE SmallCap Select index rose 0.86 per cent, and the MidCap Select index gained 0.40 per cent

» A total of 2,107 stocks advanced, while 2,076 declined and 190 remained unchanged on the BSE

» Mcap of BSE-listed cos climbed Rs 6.82 lakh cr to Rs 462,85,684.68 cr (\$4.83 trillion) in last two trading sessions

cent), Metal by 2.03 per cent, Utilities (1.59 per cent), Power (1.44 per cent), Top 10 Banks (1.40 per cent), PSU Bank and Private Banks Index by 1.38 per cent each.

A total of 2,107 stocks advanced, while 2,076 declined and 190 remained unchanged on the BSE.

The market capitalisation (mcap) of BSE-listed companies climbed by Rs 6.82 lakh crore to Rs 462,85,684.68 crore (\$4.83 trillion) in the last two trading sessions.

In Asian markets, Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Japan's Nikkei 225 benchmark ended lower, while Hong Kong's Hang Seng settled flat. However, South Korea's Kospi closed higher.

European equity markets traded in positive territory. Wall Street ended mostly higher on Wednesday.

Brent Crude, the global oil benchmark, rose nearly 1 per cent to \$106.48 per barrel.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) sold equities worth Rs 4,703.15 crore on Wednesday, while Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs) purchased stocks for Rs 5,869.05 crore, according to exchange data.

On Wednesday, the 30-share BSE Sensex rose 49.74 points to settle at 74,608.98. The 50-share NSE edged higher by 33.05 points to end at 23,412.60.

India figures in EU's draft list for continued aquaculture exports

‘India’s proposed inclusion is a major positive development for the country’s seafood export sector’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India has been included in the European Union's revised draft list for continued export of aquaculture products to the 27-nation bloc, a move that is expected to ensure uninterrupted shipments of these goods beyond September this year, an official statement said on Thursday.

The revised draft list was published by the European Union on May 12 after India undertook compliance measures in line with the European Commission Delegated Regulation, which requires exporting countries to ensure that animals and animal products exported to the EU are free from the use of antimicrobial medicines.

Earlier, India was omitted from the EU's implementing regulation issued on October 4, 2024, which had not included the country among third nations authorised to export products of animal origin intended for human consumption to the EU from September 2026.

“India's proposed inclusion is a major positive development for the country's seafood export sector and reflects the European Union's confidence in India's regulatory systems, residue monitoring mechanisms and food safety standards. Once formally adopted by the European Commission, the revised



During 2025-26, EU emerged as the third-largest market for Indian seafood exports, accounting for 18.94% of the total export value at \$1.59 billion

regulation is expected to ensure uninterrupted export of Indian aquaculture products to the EU market beyond September 2026,” the commerce ministry said.

The European Commission, in a communication dated May 12, stated that the updated list includes countries that have demonstrated compliance with EU restrictions on antimicrobial use in food-producing animals and have provided the necessary guarantees and assurances under EU regulations.

The EU is one of the key destinations for Indian seafood exports.

During 2025-26, the EU

emerged as the third-largest market for Indian seafood exports, accounting for 18.94 per cent of the total export value at \$1.59 billion.

Exports to the EU grew 41.45 per cent in value terms and 38.29 per cent in quantity during the last fiscal, with farmed shrimp constituting the major share of exports to the region.

The statement said the development recognises sustained efforts undertaken by the Department of Commerce through organisations such as Marine Products Export Development Authority and Export Inspection Council to strengthen regulatory compliance and promote responsible aquaculture practices.

It added that initiatives including the National Residue Control Programme, post-harvest testing programme, surveillance systems for banned antibiotics and stakeholder awareness programmes have strengthened India's food safety and residue monitoring framework.

Aquaculture products are fish and other aquatic animals or plants that are farmed or cultivated in water, instead of being caught from the wild. These include products such as shrimp and prawns, fish like tilapia, pangasius, salmon, seabass, crabs and lobsters, oysters, seaweed and algae.

Rupee ends marginally higher by 2 paise at 95.64 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee weakened to a fresh record low of 95.96 before closing with a marginal gain of 2 paise at 95.64 against the US dollar on Thursday, as it resisted pressure from a firm American currency and inflation worries amid elevated energy prices.

Forex traders said the rupee is expected to trade with a negative bias amid inflation concerns and the strength of the US dollar in the overseas market.

The West Asia crisis and the blockade of the Strait of Hormuz have disrupted crude petroleum imports into India.

Also, the sharp rise in crude prices has made fuel imports costlier.

The rupee has become the worst-performing currency in Asia for the year, registering a loss of over 6 per cent so far this year, as elevated crude oil prices, a strong dollar and concerns over the West Asia crisis weighed on investor sentiments, traders said.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened lower at 95.74 against the American currency.

In a volatile trade, the USD/INR pair witnessed an intra-day high of 95.61 and an all-time intraday low of 95.96 against the greenback before settling at 95.64, up 2 paise from its previous close. PFI

India bans sugar exports till Sept 30

NEW DELHI: India has banned the export of sugar till September 30 this year with immediate effect, a move which would help enhance domestic availability and contain prices.

Earlier the exports were under a restricted category, under which a license was required for the outbound shipments.

“The export policy of Sugar (Raw Sugar, White Sugar and Refined Sugar)... is amended from ‘Restricted’ to ‘Prohibited’ with immediate effect till September 30, 2026, or until further orders, whichever is earlier,” the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) said in a notification dated May 13.

This order, however, does not apply to sugar being exported to the European Union and the US under the CXL and Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ) arrangement, respectively. The arrangements allow exporters



to ship specified quantities of sugar to these destinations at significantly reduced or zero customs duties.

The DGFT's order is also not applicable to the shipments under the advance authorisation scheme, government-to-government exports and consignments already in the physical export pipeline.

For the 2025-26 sugar marketing year (October to September), the Food Ministry initially allowed 15 lakh tonnes in exports, then opened an additional 5,00,000-tonnes pool, of which only 87,587 tonnes were approved.

So, nearly 16 lakh tonnes of sugar export were allowed.

The food ministry and sugar mills were expecting 7.5-8 lakh tonnes of shipments in the entire 2025-26 marketing year.

India's sugar production rose 7.32 per cent to 27.52 million tonnes till April in the 2025-26 marketing season, driven by higher output in Maharashtra and Karnataka, according to industry body ISMA.

ISMA projected total production for the 2025-26 marketing season at 29.3 million tonnes after ethanol diversion, up from 26.12 million tonnes recorded in 2024-25.

Banning exports of a commodity helps in preventing a rise in prices, amid inflation concerns and uncertainty caused by the West Asia conflict.

In October 2022, India imposed export restriction on sugar and then it was extended from time to time. PFI

Dept of Fisheries exploring production-linked incentive scheme for MSMEs in seafood sector

NEW DELHI: The Fisheries Department will explore the possibility of formulating a production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme for MSMEs in the seafood sector, an official statement said on Thursday.

The proposal is aimed at improving international competitiveness, strengthening export-oriented infrastructure, encouraging technology adoption, supporting research and development and promoting value addition, the statement said.

“The Department of Fisheries will explore developing a dedicated PLI scheme for MSMEs in the seafood sector,” the commerce ministry said.

It said that the proposed framework aims to substantially increase the share of value-added seafood products in India's total seafood exports and



Govt has already implemented PLI scheme for 14 sectors, with an outlay of Rs 1.97 lakh crore

expand the number of exporters from around 1,200 presently to 5,000 in the coming years.

The government has already implemented the PLI scheme for 14 sectors, with an outlay of Rs 1.97 lakh crore, including white

goods, electronics and pharmaceuticals, to boost domestic manufacturing and exports. Issues related to the fisheries sector were discussed during a meeting between Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal and Minister of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying Rajiv Ranjan Singh.

They deliberated on a roadmap for accelerating the growth of India's seafood sector and strengthening the country's global export competitiveness.

It was agreed to work towards enhancing the growth of seafood exports through a coordinated strategy focused on value addition, infrastructure development, product diversification, quality assurance, market expansion, deep-sea fishing and greater stakeholder participation.

As part of this initiative, a

two-day ‘Chintan Shivir’ will be jointly organised by the ministries on 5-6 June 2026 at Visakhapatnam.

The meeting highlighted the need for an integrated approach towards addressing Sanitary and Phytosanitary (SPS) issues in aquaculture and capture fisheries.

“Efforts will be undertaken to strengthen traceability, quality assurance systems, disease-free zones and compliance with international food safety standards from the primary production stage onwards. Possibilities for GI tagging of seafood species and products will also be explored,” the ministry said.

India's marine products exports have attained an unprecedented milestone, with seafood exports touching an all-time high of Rs 72,325.82 crore (\$8.28 billion) in 2025-26. PFI

Jio Platforms appoints Akash Ambani as MD for 5 years ahead of IPO

NEW DELHI: Digital services company Jio Platforms has appointed Akash Ambani as managing director of the company ahead of its initial public offering, according to a regulatory filing.

Jio Platforms is expected to file draft papers for its IPO by the end of May or in June. “Akash M Ambani...appointed as managing director of the company, for a period of 5 years with effect from April 9, 2026,” the filing dated May 7 said.

Ambani has been on the board of Jio Platforms' telecom arm Reliance Jio Infocomm (RJIL) since October



2014. In June 2022, he was elevated to the position of Chairman of RJIL. During his tenure, Jio achieved the feat of crossing the 100 million subscriber mark in less than six months of its launch in 2016.

The company posted profit of over Rs 30,000 crore and revenue of Rs 1.46 lakh crore for fiscal year 2026. PFI

Kotak Mahindra AMC closes maiden pvt credit AIF at over ₹2,000 crore

NEW DELHI: Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Company (KMAMC) on Thursday announced the final close of its maiden private credit Alternative Investment Fund (AIF), Kotak Credit Opportunities Fund, with commitments exceeding Rs 2,000 crore.

The fund witnessed participation from High-Net-Worth Individuals, Ultra High Net Worth Individuals, family offices, corporate treasuries and institutional investors, reflecting strong investor interest in private credit as an emerging asset class. The successful close, above its initial target, underscores KMAMC's disciplined investment approach and growing credibility in alternative assets, as well as its commitment to supporting India's long-term growth with structured and solution-oriented capital.

Nilesh Shah, Managing Director, Kotak Mahindra AMC, commented, “The successful close of our maiden private credit fund marks an important milestone for our alternatives platform. The strong investor response reflects confidence in our investment philosophy and execution capabilities. We believe private credit will play an increasingly important role in India's financing ecosystem as demand for flexible capital solutions grows.”

Sunit Garg, Chief Investment Officer, Private Credit at Kotak Mahindra AMC, added, “We are encouraged by the trust reposed in us by investors. Private credit is steadily emerging as a relevant complement to traditional financing, addressing the evolving capital needs of Indian businesses. With a focus on performing credit, our approach aims to combine downside protection with stable and predictable returns for investors.”

The fund has already deployed over 50% of its corpus across diversified sectors and will continue to invest in performing credit opportunities, providing tailored capital solutions to established Indian corporates and promoters. MPOST

Arvind Kumar takes over as Director (Finance), National Fertilizers Ltd

NOIDA: Arvind Kumar has taken over as Director (Finance) of National Fertilizers Ltd (NFL), a Navratna Public Sector Enterprise under the Ministry of Chemicals & Fertilizers, Government of India. Prior to this, he was serving in senior leadership positions in the finance function in Indian Oil Corporation Ltd & Hindustan Urvarak & Rasayan Ltd. Arvind Kumar holds the educational qualifications of M.Com. Professionally, he is a Fellow Member of Institute of Cost Accountants of India and an Associate Member of Institute of Company Secretaries of India. He possesses rich and diverse experience in the areas of financial management, internal audit, budgeting, banking, taxation, commercial accounting, corporate governance and regulatory compliance. MPOST



Gold rises ₹650 to ₹1.66 lakh/10 gms, silver falls to ₹2,96,600 per kilogram

NEW DELHI: Gold price rose by Rs 650 to Rs 1.66 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Thursday after the rupee fell to a record low against the US dollar amid persistent geopolitical tensions.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, gold of 99.9 per cent purity rose Rs 650 to Rs 1,66,000/10 grams from Wednesday's closing of Rs 1,65,350/10 grams.

Silver prices, however, snapped its three-day winning streak by declining Rs 900 to



Rs 2,96,600/kg. In the previous session, the white metal had settled at Rs 2,97,500/kg, as per the association.

In the international market, spot gold edged up to \$4,704.30 per ounce, while silver slipped 0.57 per cent to \$87.04 per ounce. PFI

LIC Housing Finance March qtr PAT rises 9% to ₹1,497.41 crore

For full fiscal FY'26, the company reported 3 per cent rise in PAT to Rs 5,595.15 crore from Rs 5,429.02 crore in FY'25

MUMBAI: LIC Housing Finance on Wednesday reported a 9 per cent rise in both Profit Before Tax (PBT) and Net Profit After Tax (PAT) for Q4 FY26, driven by growth in loan disbursements and improved asset quality.

The company's PBT for Q4 FY26 stood at Rs 1,934.24 crore against Rs 1,769.58 crore in Q4 FY25. PAT during the quarter rose to Rs 1,497.41 crore from Rs 1,367.96 crore in Q4 FY25.

Total disbursements in Q4 FY26 jumped 10 per cent to Rs 21,019 crore from Rs 19,156 crore a year earlier. Disbursements in the individual home

loan segment rose 8 per cent to Rs 16,672 crore, while non-housing individual loans grew 25 per cent to Rs 3,348 crore. Project loan disbursements stood at Rs 847 crore against Rs 875 crore in the year-ago period.

Revenue from operations in Q4 FY26 stood at Rs 7,194.34 crore against Rs 7,281.17 crore in Q4 FY25.

Net Interest Income (NII) increased 3 per cent to Rs 2,221.78 crore from Rs 2,165.33 crore in Q4 FY25. Net Interest Margin (NIM) for the quarter stood at 2.80 per cent compared with 2.85 per cent in Q4 FY2025



Tribhuvan Adhikari, MD & CEO of LIC Housing Finance

and 2.69 per cent in Q3 FY2026. The individual home loan portfolio stood at Rs 2,70,893 crore as on March 31, 2026, up 4 per cent from Rs 2,61,562 crore a year ago. The project loan portfolio was at Rs 9,190 crore against Rs 9,213 crore last

CLOSER LOOK

» Total disbursements in Q4 FY26 jumped 10 per cent to Rs 21,019 crore from Rs 19,156 crore a year earlier

» Revenue from operations in Q4 FY26 stood at Rs 7,194.34 crore against Rs 7,281.17 crore in Q4 FY25

» Net Interest Income (NII) increased 3 per cent to Rs 2,221.78 crore from Rs 2,165.33 crore in Q4 FY25

year, while the total outstanding portfolio grew 4 per cent to Rs 3,20,707 crore from Rs 3,07,732 crore.

Under the Expected Credit Loss (ECL) methodology followed under IndAS norms, provisions stood at Rs 4,568.62

crore as on March 31, 2026, compared with Rs 4,899.03 crore a year ago. Stage 3 Exposure at Default improved to 2.16 per cent from 2.47 per cent as on March 31, 2025, and 2.45 per cent as on December 31, 2025.

For the full fiscal FY26, the

company reported a 3 per cent rise in PBT to Rs 7,080.62 crore from Rs 6,855.81 crore in FY25. PAT for the year increased 3 per cent to Rs 5,595.15 crore from Rs 5,429.02 crore in FY25.

Annual disbursements rose 4 per cent to Rs 66,544 crore, while revenue from operations grew 3 per cent to Rs 28,764.63 crore. NII for the year stood at Rs 8,424.52 crore, up 4 per cent year-on-year.

The company reported earnings per share of Rs 101.72 for FY26 against Rs 98.70 in FY25. The Board of Directors recommended a dividend of 500 per cent, or Rs 10 per share. MPOST



Assam University, Silchar
(A Central University)
Admission Notice for M.TECH in Computer Science & Engineering

Eligibility:
BE/B.Tech or AMIE in CSE/IT/Electronics/Electrical or equivalent with 60% marks (55% for SC/ST/PWD OR M.Sc. in Computer Science /IT/Mathematics/Physics/Electronics with 60% marks (55% for SC/ST/PWD) OR MCA with 60% marks (55% for SC/ST/PWD)

Admission Procedure:
❖Direct Admission – Valid GATE 2026 score (in relevant field), ❖CUET 2026 (by NTA) (in relevant field), ❖Departmental Admission Test (for non-CUET/GATE candidates)
❖GATE Scholarship as per AICTE. *Final year appearing/ results awaiting may also apply.

Admission Fees Structure:
Admission Fees: ₹47,520/- Total Fees (4 Semesters): ₹100,130/-

Important dates:
*Start of Online Application: 1st May, 2026 *Last Date of Online Application: 30th June, 2026
*Departmental Admission Test: 9th July, 2026
Online Application URL: aus examination.ac.in/admission/
Contact for Queries:☎: +91-9613947653 / Email: abhi.021983@gmail.com

For updates, visit www.aus.ac.in regularly

CBC 21240/11/0001/2627



ZONAL HEADQUARTERS CRIME BRANCH
JAMMU
Phone No. 0191-2544675
Fax No. 0191-2578901
e-Mail ID: sscrimejmu@jkpolice.gov.in
LOOK OUT NOTICE



The public in general is hereby informed through the medium of this **LOOK OUT NOTICE** that the present whereabouts of the below mentioned person is required for the purpose of investigation of case FIR No.306/2011 u/s 420,120-B/ RPC registered at Police station EOW, Crime Branch Jammu. Name : Manvendra Partap Singh Chauhan Son of : Than Singh Chauhan Address : H. No. 205, Tikkarmal ka Rasta, Kishanpole Bazar, Jaipur Rajasthan. Age : 44 years. Height : 5' 8" Colour : Fair Anybody having any information about the whereabouts of above named person may contact the office of Sr. Superintendent of Police EOW, Crime Branch Jammu personally or share the information on E-mail ID. sscrimejmu@jkpolice.gov.in . Telephone No. 0191-2578901 & 0191-2570060.

Sr. Superintendent of Police
EOW, Crime Branch Jammu

DIP No.:DIP/J-2051/26



E-Tender Notice

The Divisional Railway Manager (Engg)/ E.C.Railway/Samastipur for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open Tender from experienced and financially capable tenderers for the following works in e-Tendering mode of IREPS web portal of Indian Railways :- (1) **Tender Notice No.** TC-42-2026-SPJ, **Name of work:** Under water inspection by ROVs of Br. No.-50 & 51 in MNE-SHC section. Br. No. 12 in MFP-SMI section, Br. No. 89 in SMI-RXL section under SSE/BR/SPJ of Samastipur division under Dy. CE/BR/LHJP, **Tender Value** (In ₹): 914288.36, **Earnest Money** (In ₹): 18300.00, **Completion period of the work:** 06 Months (2) **Tender Notice No.** TC-43-2026-SPJ, **Name of work:** At Kaparupa construction of Limited Height Subway (LHS) and related works in lieu of LC No. 107 at Km 92/15-16 in KVC Yard under Samastipur Division., **Tender Value** (In ₹): 68235734.53, **Earnest Money** (In ₹): 1324700.00, **Completion period of the work:** 09 Months. 1. Last Date & time for receiving of Tender in E-Tender mode on IREPS web portal: 05/06/2026 upto 12.00 hours. 2. Opening Date & time for E-Tender: 05/06/2026 after 12.00 hours. 3. Website particulars where complete details of tender & tender document can be seen on Website: www.ireps.gov.in. Amendments/modifications if any shall not be published in the newspapers but the same shall be uploaded in the website.

Sr. Divisional Engineer/Co-ord E.C.Railway/Samastipur
PR/0231/SPJ/ENGGIT/26-27144



S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Tender Notice No. TRD-KGP-W-2026-27-06 dated 14.05.2026. For and on behalf of President of India, the Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD/Kharagpur-721301 invites e-tender for the following works before 15:00 hrs. on the date mentioned against items and will be opened at 15:30 hrs. **Description of works :** Replacement of composite insulator by porcelain insulator over Kharagpur Division (Phase-II). **Tender Value:** ₹ 2,65,60,840/-, **EMD :** ₹ 5,31,200/- **Cost of tender document :** Nil. **Date of Opening:** 08.06.2026. **Completion Period:** 18 months. **Date of Submission:** upto 15:00 hrs. of 08.06.2026. Interested Tenderers may visit website www.ireps.gov.in for full details, description, specification of the tender and submit their bids online. In no case manual tender for this work will be accepted. **Note:** Prospective bidders may regularly visit www.ireps.gov.in to participate in all tenders. (PR-172)



E-Tender Notice

E-TENDER NOTICE No. SG-664-04-Sig-2026-27
E-TENDER IS INVITED ON BEHALF OF THE PRESIDENT OF INDIA FOR THE UNDERMENTIONED WORK.
Sl.No.: 1. Name of the work: Replacement of defective S&T cables, Decayed/worn-out Location Boxes, overaged track relays and other equipments in the section of ASTE/BRKA, DHN DIV. **Sl.No. : 2.** Appox. Cost of the work: ₹ 6,89,79,671.45 (Approx) **Sl.No.: 3.** Earnest Money: ₹ 13,79,600.00 **Sl.No.: 4.** Date & time for closing of tender: 02.06.2026 at 12:30 Hrs. **Sl.No.: 5.** Any E-Tenders which is sent by Post / Courier / FAX or self, Manual proposals although the letter is on firm's letter pad or received in time will not be accepted. The above E-Tenders, E-Tendering document alongwith full information is available on website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in> **Note :-** Tenderers are requested to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> atleast 10 days before last date of closing for latest corrigendum / corrections etc. in response to this E-tender.

Sr. D.S.T.E.
East Central Railway, Dhanbad
PR/0221/DHN/S&T/26-27140



PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Pawan @ Arjun Bhati @ Gurjar S/o Yamuna Dass Gurjar R/o H. No. 32, Gali No. 1, A Block, Hingiri Enclave, Burari, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 97/2019 U/s 356/397/34 IPC, P.S. Mukherji Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pawan @ Arjun Bhati @ Gurjar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pawan @ Arjun Bhati @ Gurjar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Pawan @ Arjun Bhati @ Gurjar** of case **FIR No. 97/2019 U/s 356/397/34 IPC, P.S. Mukherji Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Vandana
Additional Session Judge-02
Room No. 202, Second Floor, North District
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/6138/NW/2026 (Court Matter)



NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE
Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

N.I.T. No.	NIT	04, 05, 06, 07	
1.	Name of work with its location	04 Upgradation of infrastructure on LC to be upgraded from B Class to spl Class in the section of Sr. DEN/IV of DLI Division. Similar Nature of work: Any Civil Work Other Than track Work.	
		05 Improvement of civil infrastructure at LC gates and rubberized surface in the section of DEN-IV. Similar Nature of work: Road work or LC gate road or Paving work.	
		06 Improvement of level crossing by providing rubberized surface on DLI-BTI section under jurisdiction of DEN/IV. Similar Nature of work: Road work or LC gate road or Paving work.	
		07 Provision of foot over bridge at Himmatpura, Kilazafgarh and Tohana station in the section of ADEN/JHL and ADEN/JHL. Similar Nature of work: Any Civil Work Other Than track Work.	
2.	Approx. Cost of work	04 Rs. 97732988.94 06 Rs. 84107015.58	05 Rs. 70459598.43 07 Rs. 74999813.74
3.	Earnest Money Deposit	(It should be in the form of net banking or payment gateway Only. Note:- FDR will not be accepted as EMD for tender invited on IREPS as per Railway Boards letter no.201025/ICE-IC/75/1 dated 31.08.2016)	
		04 Rs. 1954800.00	05 Rs. 1409200.00
		06 Rs. 1682200.00	07 Rs. 1500000.00
4.	Completion period of Work	04 12 Months 06 08 Months	05 08 Months 07 09 Months
5.	Date and time for submission of tender & opening of tender	Upto 15.00 hrs on 05.06.2026 Opening of tender at 15.00 hrs. On 05.06.2026.	
6.	Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in	

No.128-W/280/OET/2026-27/W+V/NIT-04, 05, 06, 07 Date 13.05.2026 1609/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.: 2120262027 Dated: 11.05.2026
E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/ North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-tenders for the following works up to 13:30 hrs. on **10.06.2026**. The details of the works are as under:-

S.N.	Tender No.	Approx Cost of work (Rs.)	Earnest Money (Rs.)
1	70	1,80,00,000.00	3,60,000.00
2	71	1,75,00,000.00	3,50,000.00
3	72	2,00,00,071.14	4,00,000.00
4	73	1,99,29,097.18	3,98,600.00
5	74	53,00,000.00	1,06,000.00
6	75	70,00,000.00	1,40,000.00

Name of Work: Annual civil maintenance, repairs and small new works in zone between the period ending on 30.06.2027 in the section of Assistant Divisional Engineer/Line/Prayagraj.

Name of Work: Annual horticulture maintenance zone works between the period ending on 30.06.2027 in the section of Assistant Divisional Engineer/Line/Prayagraj.

Name of Work: Annual horticulture maintenance zone works between the period ending on 30.06.2027 in the section of Assistant Divisional Engineer/Line/Prayagraj.

Completion Period: Up to 30.06.2027 **Date of Opening of tender:** 10.06.2026

Minimum Eligibility Criteria for "Similar work": For S.N. 1 & 2-Any P. Way work, for S.N. 3 & 4- Any Civil Engineering work and for S.N. 5 & 6- Any Horticulture work

Note: 1. E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. 2. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.ireps.gov.in. up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e. **10.06.2026**. 3. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 4. Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/ letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. 5. The tenderers shall submit a certificate as given in tender document as "Annexure" in standard format without which their tender may not be considered and shall be summarily rejected. 6. The supplier/ contractor of goods and /or services would be subject to GST Act and Rules as applicable from time to time. 7. Document being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. 8. This tender notice has also been uploaded on www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in. 9. Payment of Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) in respect of e-tendering shall be accepted through net banking or payment gateway only. 10. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 11. Tender on line can be submitted up to 13.30 hrs. of tender opening date i.e. **10.06.2026**. 12. The tenderer has to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-I) of GCC-2022 mandatorily, otherwise offer will be considered as Incomplete Offer and accordingly shall not be considered. **1070/26 (ADM)**

f North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 03/2026 Dt. 12.05.2026
E-Procurement Tender Notice

S. N.	Tender No.	Description	Qty.	EMD (Rs.)
1	13265173	Main LED Signal Lamp (Green Aspect)	657 Nos	₹ 121730

Tender Opening Date: 01.06.2026

Note: (1) The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender is available on IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tender, for this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Class III Digital Signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letterhead if attached by tender shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed on their body. 5. Allocation for "Cost of Drawing" is Z-650 and for "Earnest Money deposit (EMD)" is Deposit Misc. stores- 00844517. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the IREPS website may be approached. **1077/26 FA**

f North central railways @ @CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No.: SIG-WS-CONT-AGC-104 Dated: 12.05.2026
TENDER NOTICE (Single Packet System)

Dy. Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/Con/Agra, North Central Railway Unit, Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites open e-Tender for as per following details of the work on Single Packet System. If date of opening is declared a holiday or offer could not be opened due to Technical issue, the offers shall be opened on the next working day.

Name of Work: Design, Manufacturing, Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of New Electronic Interlocking at Bateshwar in connection with conversion of class D to class B station including all Indoor & Outdoor signaling and Telecom work of Agra division of North Central Railway.

Estimated Cost of Work: Approx. ₹ 52855018.87 only (Rupees Five Crore Twenty Eight Lakh Fifty Five Thousand Eighteen and Eighty Seven Only).

Earnest Money: ₹ 1057100.00 (Ten Lakh Fifty Seven Thousand One Hundred only).

Tender Form Cost: NIL. **Completion Period:** 06 Months.

Availability of Tender Form: Tender forms shall be available on web site, www.ireps.gov.in, 21 days prior to date of opening of the tender.

Closing Date/Time of Tender: 03.06.2026 before 15:00 Hrs
Tender Opening Date/Time: 03.06.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.

Place of Opening: Through Online E-Portal www.ireps.gov.in in the office of Dy.CSTE/IC/AGC Office, AGRA (UP)

Validity of Offer: 60 days from date of opening.

Right of Railway to deal with Tender: Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons.

Tenderers who wish to participate in tenders invited on www.ireps.gov.in have to register on the website mandatorily. Please refer to website for more details. Payment of earnest money can be made through net banking, debit/credit card etc or as per GCC. Further particulars can be obtained from Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. **1081/26 (A)**

f North central railways @ @CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice 04/2026 dated 12.05.2026
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

Tender no. : 13265181A **Qty :** 1440 Nos **EMD (Rs.) :** 172850/-
Description : Supply of LED Signal (SHUNT Aspect)
Tender Opening Date. : 15.06.2026

Note: (1)The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender are available on IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tender. For this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Class III Digital Signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed on their body. (5) Allocation for "Cost of Drawing" is Z-650 and for "Earnest Money deposit (EMD)" is Deposit Misc. stores - 00844517. • In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the IREPS website may be approached. **1079/26 (AS)**

f North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.T-05-N-2026-27 Dated: 12.05.2026
E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (General) N.C. Railway, Agra on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on line only (E-Tendering) for the following works.

Name of work with its location & Completion Period: Agra Division-
Provision of Solar Street Light over Agra Division.
Completion period : 08 months.

Approx. Cost of the work: ₹ 20759161.00

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in Tenders can only be submitted through web portal www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs on 08.06.2026 **1080/26 (DG)**

f North central railways @ @CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No: 02/2026 Dated: 12.05.2026
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

SN	Tender no.	Description	Qty	EMD (Rs)	Tender Opening Date
1	13265175	Main LED Signal Lamp (RED Aspect)	703 Nos	117170/-	08.06.2026

Note: 1. The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender are available on IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tender. For this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with class III digital signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 3. Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. 4. Documents being attached should be signed on their body. 5. Allocation for "Cost of Drawing" is Z-650 and for "Earnest Money deposit (EMD)" is Deposit Misc. stores - 00844517. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the IREPS website may be approached. **1078/26 (ADM)**

f North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. - P/Agra/settlement/Pension Adalat/15 June 2026 Dated:12/05/2026
Notification

Pension Adalat to be conducted by North Central Railway, Agra

As per the guidelines issued by Railway Board and HQ office, Prayagraj, Pension Adalat will be organised by Agra Division, North Central Railway on 15th June 2026 (Monday) at 11-00 o'clock. The Pensioner / Family pensioners retired w.e.f. December 2003 only from Agra division may submit their grievances if any, related to pension or settlement payment in the given format, latest by 05.06.2026 at the following address :-

Address for application
Sr. Divisional Personnel Officer (settlement) North Central Railway Agra
Venue of pension adalat
Govardhan Meeting Hall, DRM office building North Central Railway Agra (From: 11:00 hrs)

Format of Application

1. Name of the applicant:-	7. Nature of retirement (Normal/VR/CR):-
2. Name of the Ex. Employee:-	8. P.P.O. No. (Photocopy to enclosed):-
3. Designation & Last Place of Posting:-	9. Last pay Drawn & Scale of Pay:-
4. Relation of the applicant with Ex-Employee:-	10. Mobile No. and email id:-
5. Present Postal Address:-	11. Grievance in detail:-
6. Date of retirement:-	Signature of the applicant

Note :- Please mention "Pension Adalat 15 June 2026" on the top of the envelope.

Assistant Personnel Officer
N.C.Railway, Agra

1072/26 (DG)
f North central railways @ @CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



UJVN Limited

H.O.: "UJJAWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135-2763808; Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website : www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 409 E-Tender Notice Dated : 13/05/2026
Office of the EE(IC&M) Ganga Bhawan, Yamuna Colony, Dehradun, invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No: 01/EE(IC&M)/2026-27
Name of work/ Supply/Service: Procurement of testing equipments for different power houses of UJVN Ltd.
Estimated cost : 1,56,02,515.00 GST Extra
Date of availability of bid documents on website: 14.05.2026 from 16:00Hrs.
Last date for submission of bids on website: 04.06.2026 up to 17:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "http://uktenders.gov.in"
EE(IC&M)



यूनियन बैंक ऑफ इंडिया Union Bank of India

REGIONAL OFFICE - New Delhi, 1, Faiz Road, Jhandewalan, New Delhi-110005, E-mail : cb8821rec@unionbankofindia.bank

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable/Movable Assets on 12.06.2026 between 12:00 PM to 05:00 PM (with unlimited extension of 10 minutes each) under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 9/ 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rule, 2002 Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor (s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged and charged to the Secured Creditor, the possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer of Union Bank of India (secured creditor), will be sold on As is where is. As is what is and "Whatever there is" on the date mentioned hereunder for recovery of dues as mentioned hereunder to Union Bank of India from the below mentioned Borrower(s) & Guarantor(s). The Reserve Price and the Earnest Money Deposit are also mentioned hereunder

S. No.	Name of the Branch	Name & address of Borrower & Guarantor	Details of Property	Constructive or Physical Possession taken	Total Dues	Reserve Price	Name & Contact No. of Authorized Officer
1	Uttam Nagar (24541)	1. Mr. Dablu Kumar (Borrower) WZ 98, Naraina Village, South West Delhi – 110028 24A, Nangli Sakrawati Extn, Part 1, Najafgarh, Delhi - 110043 2. Mr. Prabhu Nath Singh (Guarantor) WZ 624, Naraina Village, South west Delhi, Delhi - 110028	3RD Floor with roof right, Plot No. RZ-7-2/A, KH No. 16/14, Nanda Block, Village – Mirzapur , Mahavir Enclave, New Delhi – 110045. Area of property 42 Sq. mtrs. North By Road – 20 Ft South by other's Property East by other's Property West By Gali 10 Ft.	Physical	Rs. 11.99 lacs +interest +Expenses (As on date)	21,24,000.00 2,12,400.00 20,000.00	Ms. Ankita Rajput 7757016816
2	SB Sarafa Market (30770)	1. Ahmadi Khatoun 2. Juned Shmed Khan A-6/4A, Ground Floor, DLF, Ankur Vihar, Loni Ghaziabad	Residential Property : Flat no. GF-2, ground floor, Plot no. A-6/4A, DLF colony, Ankur Vihar, Loni Tehsil, District Ghaziabad, UP, Area -83.61 Ssq.m. or 900 sq.ft	Physical	Rs. 17.41 lacs +interest+expenses (as on date)	15,30,000.00 1,53,000.00 20,000.00	Ms. Ankita Rajput 7757016816
3	VISHWAS NAGAR (06281)	1. M/s. Parmanand Medicos (Prop. Devesh Kumar) At: Shop no. 13, Plot no. 12, Block-B, Shalimar Garden Extension-2, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, UP-201005 2. Mr. Devesh Kumar At: Flat no. 306, 2nd Floor, Plot no. 13, Block-B, Shalimar Garden Extension-II, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, UP-201005	"RESIDENTIAL FLAT NO. 306 ON SECOND FLOOR, LIG TYPE, (with roof rights and without parking), PLOT NO. 13, BLOCK -B, SHALIMAR GARDEN EXTENSION-II, SAHIBABAD, GHAZIABAD, UP-201005." North: Flat no. 305 West: Flat no. 304 Area: 400 Sq. ft. East: Balcony & Service Lane Carpet Area: 360 Sq.Ft.	Physical	Rs. 23.77 lacs +interest+expenses (as on date)	17,15,000.00 1,71,500.00 20,000.00	Ms. Ankita Rajput 7757016816

BRIEF TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF E-AUCTION SALE : The sale shall be subject to the Terms & Conditions prescribed in the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002 and to the following further conditions : (1) The Properties are being sold on "AS IS WHERE IS BASIS" and "AS IS WHAT IS BASIS" and " WHATEVER THERE IS BASIS". (2) The particulars of Secured Assets specified in the Schedule herein above stated to the best of the information of the Authorised Officer, but the Authorised Officer shall not be answerable for any error, misstatement or omission in this proclamation. (3) The sale will be done through e-auction platform provided at the Website <https://baanknet.com>. on date and time of auction specified above. (4) Bank reserves the rights to cancel/postpone the auction at any point of time. (5) For further details and complete Terms & Conditions of the sale, please refer : <http://www.unionbankofindia.co.in/english/TenderViewAllAuction.aspx> (6). Interested person may also contact the concerned authorised officer.

Date: 15.05.2026 Place: New Delhi

Authorised Officer, Union Bank of India



‘THOROUGHLY ENJOYED WORKING WITH SAIF’

Dugal stars with Khan in the ‘Netflix’ film ‘Kartavya’

Rasika Dugal, who will be seen sharing the screen with Bollywood actor Saif Ali Khan for the first time in ‘Kartavya’, revealed what quality of Saif she admired and also tried to imbibe during the shoot.

The ‘Mirzapur’ actress shared that some actors are naturally capable of not just performing their parts but also being fully aware of all that is taking place on the set, something which Rasika admittedly struggles to do. She confessed that while on the set, she often remains in her own head, unable to carry others with her. When asked what she unlearned on the sets of ‘Kartavya’, Rasika said, “There are some actors who are able to sort of understand what is happening on the set entirely and do their job also, which I saw Saif do very beautifully.”

“I feel that sometimes when I am on set, I can only be in my own head a little bit and not really be able to carry everybody together with me, and not even sort of take on that responsibility. So, I unlearned how to do that because I saw him do that so beautifully,” she added.



The ‘Mirzapur’ star revealed what she had to ‘unlearn’ while working on the film

Previously, Rasika shared her experience of working with Saif. She revealed that she found the ‘Cocktail’ actor extremely fun to work with. “It’s great to have a co-actor who has a super sense of humour and is so much fun to work with! I really admire how he has sustained a successful career for over three decades and constantly reinvented himself. I thoroughly enjoyed working with him,” she said.

Directed and written by Pulkit, ‘Kartavya’ also features Sanjay Mishra, Zakir Hussain, Manish Chaudhari and Saurabh Dwivedi in significant roles, along with others. The film is slated to premiere on streaming giant ‘Netflix’ today. AGENCIES

‘They want to show you the mirror’

Tabu opened up about the unfair pressure of ageism women face in cinema

Tabu has always chosen roles that truly connect with her, stayed away from unnecessary drama and spoken with an honesty rarely seen among celebrities. In a recent interview, she spoke openly about ageing, the pressure women in cinema face and why she never learned to give safe and careful answers like most people in the industry do.

In a candid chat with ‘Harper’s Bazaar India’, Tabu touched upon a topic that hits close to home for many women in the film industry, pointing out how society tends to obsess over a woman’s age far more than the woman herself ever does.

“People are more worried about your age than you are yourself. They want to show you the mirror, as though you don’t have one at home,” she said.

She pushed back against the idea that ageing is a dramatic, overnight change, explaining that it happens slowly and steadily over time and everyone who has lived through it knows this better than anyone else.

“The person answering that question hasn’t aged overnight. We experience it every single day. It’s not like one day someone wakes up at 20 and the next day they turn 45,” she added.

The actress also shared an interesting insight about how things work in the film industry when it comes to saying no to a project. She revealed that people



She pushed back against the idea that ageing is a dramatic and overnight change

around her often advised her not to be too honest when turning down a film and that the general expectation was to avoid giving a real opinion about a script and simply blame it on busy schedules instead.

“You should not give a real reason for not doing a film,” she said while recalling the advice she received. AGENCIES

SEE YOU AT WORK TOMORROW!

From burnout to butterflies

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Get ready to fall in love... right at your desk. ‘Prime Video’ announced June 22 as the global premiere date for its upcoming Korean series ‘See You at Work Tomorrow!’

If you’ve ever caught feelings between meetings or found sparks in the most unexpected places, this one’s for you. Blending sharp workplace satire with slow-burn romance, ‘See You at Work Tomorrow!’ delivers a fresh, relatable take on office life, where deadlines are tight, emotions run high and love might just be the most unpredictable project of all.

Led by fan-favourite stars Seo In-guk (‘Boyfriend on Demand’, ‘Death’s Game’, ‘Doom at Your Service’) and Park Ji-hyun (‘You and Everything Else’, ‘Hidden Face’, ‘Flex x Cop’), the series follows Cha Ji-yoon, a once-driven product planner now running on autopilot and her notoriously icy boss Kang Si-woo, a man known throughout the office as the ‘Three-No Man’: no smiles, no small talk, no apologies.



But beneath his frosty exterior? A hidden warmth that slowly begins to surface, especially when Ji-yoon enters his world.

Ji-yoon, on the other hand, has mastered the art of doing just enough to get by. By day, she’s

dependable and composed; by night, she’s all about comfort food, gaming and keeping life - and love - strictly low-stakes. Burned by the past, she’s locked her heart away until Si-woo’s quiet sincerity starts to break through her care-

The ‘Prime Video’ upcoming series is led by fan-favourite stars Seo In-guk and Park Ji-hyun

fully built walls.

Based on the hit ‘Kakao Webtoon’ by ‘McQueen Studio’, the series captures the reality of modern work culture with humour, heart and just the right amount of emotional chaos. It’s about showing up - even when life feels overwhelming - and discovering that sometimes, the most meaningful connections happen when you least expect them.

Produced by ‘Studio Dragon’ and ‘Kross Pictures’, the series is directed by Cho Eun-sol (‘Perfect Shot’, ‘My Beautiful Apartment’) and written by Kim Kyung-min (‘Born Again’ co-writer).

So, mark your calendars: June 22 is your next must-watch day. Because this time, clocking in might just mean falling in love.

Peter Jackson doesn’t dislike AI as long as it comes with right permissions

Lord of the Rings’ director Peter Jackson said he isn’t averse to AI in films as the technology isn’t very different from other special effects. The Oscar-winning filmmaker said that as long as permission is obtained to use an actor’s likeness, there shouldn’t be an issue with the use of technology, reported ‘Variety’.

But with AI becoming popular, Jackson is worried that it will affect actors performing motion capture, like Andy Serkis as Gollum in his JJR



Tolkien adaptations.

“I don’t dislike it at all. I mean, to me, it’s just a special effect. It’s no different from other special effects. If you’re doing an AI duplicate of somebody, like Indiana Jones

But with AI becoming popular, the filmmaker is worried that it will affect actors performing motion capture

or anyone else, as long as you’ve licensed the rights from the person you’re showing, I don’t see the issue. It’s when people’s likenesses get stolen and usurped,” the director said.

Jackson said the ongoing debate on AI will have an impact on people’s perception of motion-capture performances, where actors record their movement in specialised suits, which then turn the performance into 3D animated digital characters, a prime example being Serkis’ Gollum.

“A lot of the current environment, everyone’s so worried about AI... I don’t think a Gollum-type character or a generated character has any hope for winning any awards,” Jackson said. PFI

Netflix announces global concert tour for ‘KPop Demon Hunters’

A waitlist for ticket and tour information is currently live

Netflix is launching a global concert tour based on its Oscar-winning animated film ‘KPop Demon Hunters’, the streaming giant announced. The OTT platform shared the news during its upfront presentation to advertisers in New York on Wednesday, reported ‘Variety’.

Produced in partnership with Los Angeles-based live entertainment company ‘AEG Presents’, the tour promises to bring elements of the blockbuster film to life in what ‘Netflix’ described as ‘spectacular ways’. A waitlist for ticket and tour information is currently live, with city dates and venues to be announced later this year.

“Nothing has captured the world’s attention quite like ‘KPop Demon Hunters’. There were sing-alongs, Halloween costumes, shoutouts at the US Open and Buckingham Palace. There was even a 25 per cent spike in flights booked to Korea. And today, ‘KPop Demon Hunters’ is still the most popular film on ‘Netflix’ and we’re really excited to announce that next year, in partnership with ‘AEG Presents’, we’re going to keep that momentum going with



The tour promises to bring elements of the blockbuster film to life in what ‘Netflix’ described as ‘spectacular ways’

our very first world concert tour,” Netflix’s president of Ad Sales Amy Reinhard told the upfront audience.

She added, “The live tour is going to bring fans even closer to the characters and the music that they love and of course, we want you to be a part of that. We’ll have more

information to share about the cities later this year, so stay tuned.”

The animated film, directed by Maggie Kang and Chris Appelhans from a screenplay by Kang, centres on three K-pop stars, Rumi, Mira and Zoey, who perform as the internationally famous girl group ‘HUNTR/X’ while secretly operating as demon hunters protecting the world from supernatural threats. The story draws on Korean folklore and pits the trio against the Saja Boys, a rival boy band revealed to be demons in disguise.

‘Netflix’ is currently developing a sequel with Kang and Appelhans. PFI

Aamir opens up about his four decades in Bollywood

Throughout this journey, Khan has always managed to surprise his audience

Aamir Khan has been a part of Indian cinema for nearly four decades and throughout this journey, he has always managed to surprise his audience. He has done all kinds of films like love stories, comedies, socially important films and big commercial entertainers. He takes his time, chooses his projects carefully and has always believed in quality over quantity.

In a candid conversation with ‘Variety India’, Aamir looked back on some of the defining moments of his personal and professional life. When asked about the most dangerous stunt he has ever performed on camera, he didn’t hold back. “First stunt I don’t remember, but the most dangerous stunt I performed was running in front of a train. It was a little too much, but luckily nothing happened,” he recalled.



Aamir looked back on some of the defining moments of his personal and professional life

Despite being one of the biggest names in the industry today, Aamir revealed that his first major splurge was anything but extravagant. “I think the most expensive thing I bought was probably my first house. Yeah, that was the first thing I bought,” he said.

The actor also shared that

‘Delhi Belly’ was the first script that kept him hooked through the night, reading it in one go, a fact that makes perfect sense given how the 2011 dark comedy went on to become one of the most celebrated cult films under his production banner.

Aamir also talked about his early days in the industry and shared fond memories of working with Juhi Chawla and Madhuri Dixit, who were his co-stars in some of the biggest films of the 1990s. When asked about a song that became a cultural moment, Aamir didn’t have to think twice. “Papa kehte hai, yeah, I guess,” he said, pointing to the beloved song from his very first film ‘Qayamat Se Qayamat Tak’, which is still remembered and loved by many.

A waitlist for ticket and tour information is currently live AGENCIES

